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System and method for instruction unwinding in an out-of-order processor

Abstract

A system and corresponding method unwind instructions in an out-of-order (OoO) processor. The system comprises a mapper. In response to a restart event causing at least one instruction to be unwound, the mapper restores a present integer mapper state and present floating-point (FP) mapper state, used for mapping instructions, to a former integer mapper state and former FP mapper state, respectively. The mapper stores integer snapshots and FP snapshots of the present integer and FP mapper state, respectively, to expedite restoration to the former integer and FP mapper state, respectively. Access to the FP snapshots is blocked, intermittently, as a function of at least one FP present indicator used by the mapper to record presence of FP registers used as destinations in the instructions. Blocking the access, intermittently, improves power efficiency of the OoO processor.

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Background/Summary

RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) This application is a continuation of U.S. application Ser. No. 17/246,428, filed Apr. 30, 2021, now U.S. Pat. No. 11,593,116, which is a continuation of U.S. application Ser. No. 16/447,470, filed Jun. 20, 2019, now U.S. Pat. No. 11,036,515. The entire teachings of the above applications are incorporated herein by reference.

BACKGROUND

(1) Out-of-order (OoO) execution is employed by most high-performance processors to make use of instruction cycles that would otherwise be wasted. A processor that executes instructions OoO is referred to as an OoO processor and executes instructions OoO relative to an original order of the instructions in a program, that is, a program order of the instructions that is generated by a compiler.

(2) By executing instructions OoO, the OoO processor can avoid being idle while waiting for a preceding instruction to complete and can, in the meantime, process one or more next instructions that are able to run immediately and independently. An OoO processor relies on register renaming which is an operation that renames architectural (i.e., logical) registers in an instruction with physical registers of the OoO processor. Such a renaming operation may be referred to interchangeably herein as instruction mapping.

(3) Register renaming eliminates false data dependencies that arise from reuse of architectural registers by successive instructions that do not have any real data dependencies between them. The elimination of these false data dependencies reveals more instruction-level parallelism in an

instruction stream, which can be exploited by OoO execution for better performance.

SUMMARY

(4) According to an example embodiment, a system for unwinding instructions in an out-of-order (OoO) processor may comprise a mapper. The mapper may be configured, in response to a restart event causing at least one instruction to be unwound, to restore a present integer mapper state and present floating-point (FP) mapper state to a former integer mapper state and former FP mapper state, respectively. The present integer and FP mapper state may be used by the mapper for mapping instructions. The system may further comprise integer snapshot circuitry and FP snapshot circuitry configured to store integer snapshots and FP snapshots of the present integer and FP mapper state, respectively, to expedite restoration to the former integer and FP mapper state, respectively. Access to the FP snapshot circuitry may be blocked, intermittently, as a function of at least one FP present indicator used by the mapper to record presence of FP architectural registers (ARs) used as destinations in the instructions.

(5) Restoring the present integer and FP mapper state to the former integer and FP mapper state, respectively, causes the former integer and FP mapper state to become the present integer and FP mapper state, respectively.

(6) The system may further comprise an integer register mapper table and integer physical register (PR) free list. The present integer mapper state may represent the integer register mapper table in its present state and the integer PR free list in its present state. Each integer snapshot of the integer snapshots may include respective copies of the integer register mapper table and integer PR free list stored at a respective point in time. In response to the restart event, the mapper may be further configured to select a given integer snapshot of the integer snapshots, copy a given integer-register-map snapshot and given integer-PR-free-list snapshot of the given integer snapshot to the integer register mapper table and integer PR free list, respectively, and modify the integer register mapper table and integer PR free list based on the journal.

(7) The system may further comprise an FP register mapper table and FP PR free list. The present FP mapper state may represent the FP register mapper table in its present state and the FP PR free list in its present state. Each FP snapshot of the FP snapshots may include respective copies of the FP register mapper table and FP PR free list stored at a respective point in time. In response to the restart event, the mapper may be further configured to select a given FP snapshot of the FP snapshots, copy, in an event the access is not blocked, a given FP-register-map snapshot and given FP-PR-free-list snapshot of the given FP snapshot to the FP register mapper table and FP PR free list, respectively, and modify the FP register mapper table and FP PR free list based on the journal.

(8) The system may further comprise a journal. In response to the restart event, the mapper may be further configured to use a mapper identifier to locate a given entry in the journal. The mapper identifier is received by the mapper with a notification of the restart event. The mapper identifier and given entry are associated with a given instruction that is associated with the restart event.

(9) The journal may be partitioned into a plurality of sections with boundaries therebetween. The at least one FP present indicator may include a plurality of FP present indicators. Each FP present indicator of the plurality of FP present indicators may be associated with a respective section of the plurality of sections.

(10) The mapper may be further configured to block access to the FP snapshot circuitry in an event each FP present indicator of the plurality of FP present indicators is clear and to enable access to the FP snapshot circuitry in an event at least a single FP present indicator of the plurality of FP present indicators is set.

(11) The journal may be a circular buffer configured to store at most a maximum number of entries. The at least one FP present indicator may be a counter. The mapper may be further configured to set the counter to twice the maximum number of entries each time the mapper maps a received instruction that uses at least one FP architectural register (AR) as a destination. The mapper may be further configured to decrement the counter each time the mapper maps a received instruction that

does not use at least one FP AR as a destination. It should be noted that such decrementing of the counter saturates at zero and, thus, the counter does not go negative. In response to the restart event, the mapper may be further configured to set the counter to twice the maximum number of entries in an event the counter is non-zero. The mapper may be further configured to block access to the FP snapshot circuitry in an event the counter is zero and to enable access to the FP snapshot circuitry in an event the counter is non-zero.

(12) The journal may be configured to store integer mapper state changes made to the present integer mapper state by the mapper and to store FP mapper state changes made to the present FP mapper state by the mapper.

(13) The integer mapper state changes are caused by mapping integer ARs used as destinations in the instructions to integer physical registers (PRs) of the OoO processor and the FP mapper state changes are caused by mapping the FP ARs used as destinations in the instructions to FP PRs of the OoO processor.

(14) The journal may be a circular buffer with a head pointer configured to point to a head entry and a tail pointer configured to point to a tail entry. A depth of entries of the circular buffer is based on a difference between the head and tail pointers and the given entry is located within a given section of the plurality of sections.

(15) In an event the head entry is not in the given section and, in an event the head entry is in the given section and the depth is greater than a length of the given section, to restore the present integer and FP mapper state to the former integer and FP mapper state, respectively, the mapper may be further configured to copy a given integer snapshot of the integer snapshots to the present integer mapper state and to copy a given FP snapshot of the FP snapshots to the present FP mapper state. Copying of the given FP snapshot is prevented in an event access to the FP snapshot circuitry is blocked as a function of the at least one FP present indicator.

(16) The length of the given section may be 32 entries.

(17) The given integer snapshot and given FP snapshot may be associated with a given boundary of the boundaries. The given boundary separates the given section and a next section of the plurality of sections. The given boundary is crossed as a function of the mapper transitioning from writing to the given section in the circular buffer to writing to the next section in the circular buffer.

(18) The mapper may be further configured to use the mapper identifier to select the given integer snapshot from among the integer snapshots and to select the given FP snapshot from among the FP snapshots.

(19) In an event the given entry is not a last entry of the given section, the mapper may be further configured to read, without affecting the tail pointer, from the circular buffer in a backward direction, starting with the last entry. The mapper may be further configured to read, in reverse order, each subsequent entry of at least one subsequent entry that was added to the given section, in a forward direction, subsequent to adding the given entry to the given section. The reverse order is reverse relative to a fill order used to add the given entry and the at least one subsequent entry. The backward direction is opposite the forward direction. The mapper may be further configured to move the head pointer to point to a next entry in the circular buffer. The next entry immediately follows the given entry in the forward direction.

(20) In an event the subsequent entry read includes at least one integer mapper state change of the integer mapper state changes, the mapper may be further configured to unwind, from the present integer mapper state, each integer mapper state change of the at least one integer mapper state change. The integer mapper state change may be unwound by changing a present mapping in the integer register mapper table, that is between an integer AR and a present integer PR, to a former mapping, that is between the integer AR and a former integer PR, and returning the present integer PR to the integer PR free list. The integer AR and former integer PR are included in the subsequent entry that is read.

(21) In an event the subsequent entry read includes at least one FP mapper state change of the FP

mapper state changes, the mapper may be further configured to unwind, from the present FP mapper state, each FP mapper state change of the at least one FP mapper state change. The FP mapper state change may be unwound by changing a present mapping in the FP register mapper table, that is between an FP AR and a present FP PR, to a former mapping, that is between the FP AR and a former FP PR, and returning the present FP PR to the FP PR free list. The FP AR and former FP PR are included in the subsequent entry that is read.

(22) The at least one instruction to be unwound is subsequent to the given instruction in a program order and executed by an execution unit prior to execution of the given instruction by the execution unit.

(23) In an event the head entry is in the given section and the depth is not greater than the length of the given section, to restore the present integer and FP mapper state to the former integer and FP mapper state, respectively, the mapper is further configured to read, without affecting the tail pointer, from the circular buffer in a backward direction, starting with a preceding entry. The preceding entry precedes the head entry. The mapper reads, in reverse order, each subsequent entry of at least one subsequent entry located in the given section between the head entry and the given entry. The reverse order is reverse relative to a fill order used to add, in a forward direction, the given entry and each subsequent entry of the at least one subsequent entry to the given section. The backward direction is opposite the forward direction. The mapper is further configured to move the head pointer to point to a next entry in the circular buffer. The next entry immediately follows the given entry in the forward direction.

(24) According to another example embodiment, a method for unwinding instructions in an out-of-order (OoO) processor comprises, in response to a restart event causing at least one instruction to be unwound, restoring a present integer mapper state and present floating-point (FP) mapper state to a former integer mapper state and former FP mapper state, respectively. The present integer and FP mapper state are used for mapping instructions. The method may further comprise storing integer snapshots and FP snapshots of the present integer and FP mapper state in integer snapshot circuitry and FP snapshot circuitry, respectively, to expedite the restoring. The method may further comprise blocking access to the FP snapshot circuitry, intermittently, as a function of at least one FP present indicator used by the mapper to record presence of FP architectural registers (ARs) used as destinations in the instructions.

(25) Alternative method embodiments parallel those described above in connection with the example system embodiment.

(26) According to another example embodiment, a system for mapping and unwinding instructions in an out-of-order (OoO) processor comprises a mapper. The mapper may be configured to use integer mapper state and floating-point (FP) mapper state for mapping instructions and may be configured to record, via at least one FP present indicator, presence of FP architectural registers used as destinations in the instructions. The system may comprise integer snapshot circuitry and FP snapshot circuitry configured to store integer snapshots and FP snapshots of the integer and FP mapper state, respectively. The mapper may be further configured to (i) write to the integer and FP snapshot circuitry, periodically, and (ii) read from the integer and FP snapshot circuitry responsive to a restart event causing at least one instruction to be unwound. The mapper may be blocked, intermittently, as a function of the at least one FP present indicator, from writing to and reading from the FP snapshot circuitry.

(27) To write to the integer and FP snapshot circuitry, the mapper may be further configured to copy the integer mapper state to a given integer snapshot of the integer snapshots; and to copy the FP mapper state to a given FP snapshot of the FP snapshots.

(28) To read from the integer and FP snapshot circuitry, the mapper may be further configured to copy a given integer snapshot of the integer snapshots to the integer mapper state and to copy a given FP snapshot of the FP snapshots to the FP mapper state.

(29) According to another example embodiment, a method for mapping and unwinding instructions

in an out-of-order (OoO) processor may comprise using integer mapper state and floating-point (FP) mapper state for mapping instructions. The method may further comprise recording, via at least one FP present indicator, presence of FP architectural registers used as destinations in the instructions. The method may further comprise writing to integer snapshot circuitry and FP snapshot circuitry, periodically. The method may further comprise reading from the integer and FP snapshot circuitry responsive to a restart event causing at least one instruction to be unwound. The method may further comprise blocking, intermittently, as a function of the at least one FP present indicator, the writing to and reading from the FP snapshot circuitry.

(30) Writing to the integer snapshot circuitry may include copying the integer mapper state to a given integer snapshot of the integer snapshots and writing to the FP snapshot circuitry may include copying the FP mapper state to a given FP snapshot of the FP snapshots.

(31) Reading from the integer snapshot circuitry may include copying a given integer snapshot of the integer snapshots to the integer mapper state and reading from the FP snapshot circuitry may include copying a given FP snapshot of the FP snapshots to the FP mapper state.

(32) It should be understood that example embodiments disclosed herein can be implemented in the form of a method, apparatus, system, or computer readable medium with program codes embodied thereon.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) The foregoing will be apparent from the following more particular description of example embodiments, as illustrated in the accompanying drawings in which like reference characters refer to the same parts throughout the different views. The drawings are not necessarily to scale, emphasis instead being placed upon illustrating embodiments.

(2) FIG. 1A is a block diagram of an example embodiment of a system for mapping and unwinding instructions in an out-of-order (OoO) processor.

(3) FIG. 1B is a block diagram of an example embodiment of the system of FIG. 1A that may be used for mapping instructions in the OoO processor.

(4) FIG. 1C is a block diagram of an example embodiment of an integer-register mapper table and an integer physical register (PR) free list.

(5) FIG. 1D is a block diagram of an example embodiment of a floating-point (FP) register mapper table and an FP-PR free list.

(6) FIG. 1E is a block diagram of an example embodiment of a journal, integer snapshot circuitry, and FP snapshot circuitry.

(7) FIG. 1F is a block diagram of an example embodiment of at least one FP present indicator.

(8) FIG. 1G is a block diagram of an example embodiment of the system of FIG. 1A that may be used for unwinding instructions in the OoO processor.

(9) FIG. 2 is a block diagram of an example embodiment of a journal.

(10) FIG. 3 is a flow diagram of an example embodiment of a method for instruction mapping in an OoO processor.

(11) FIG. 4 is a flow diagram of an example embodiment of a method for unwinding instructions in an OoO processor.

(12) FIG. 5 is a flow diagram of a method for mapping and unwinding instructions in an OoO processor.

(13) FIG. 6 is a block diagram of an example embodiment of a network services processor in which an example embodiment may be implemented.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(14) A description of example embodiments follows.

(15) An out-of-order (OoO) processor employs a mapping function. In the mapping function, all of the source and destination registers for an instruction are “mapped” from architectural registers (ARs) to physical registers (PRs) by a mapper, such as the mapper **102** of FIGS. **1B-C**, disclosed further below. Mapping an architectural register (AR) used as a destination in the instruction causes a state of the mapper to change. Using an AR as a destination results in a write to that AR. To map an AR used as a destination, the mapper finds a “free” physical register (PR) that is not presently mapped to any AR. The mapper changes the state of the mapper by changing a mapping between the AR and a given PR to a mapping between the AR and the free register.

(16) As such, multiple instructions that use a same AR as a destination do not interfere with one another as the multiple instructions use different PRs as the destinations based on the change in AR-to-PR mapping. According to an example embodiment, a journal (also referred to interchangeably herein as a reorder buffer), such as the journal **130** of FIG. **1E**, or the journal **130** of FIG. **1F**, disclosed further below, may be used to store a history of what actions are taken by the mapper to map the instruction. Such history includes AR-to-PR mapping changes caused by mapping ARs used as destination registers in the instructions.

(17) For example, if an instruction uses AR A as a destination, a given journal entry associated with that instruction may be used to store a state change, such as AR A was equal to PR 1 but is now equal to PR 0, while another journal entry associated with a different instruction may indicate that no state change resulted from mapping the different instruction. For example, no state change occurs if an instruction does not use an AR as a destination. Such a history allows the OoO processor to be backed up to a former state in an event an exception occurs.

(18) In the event the exception occurs in the OoO processor, such as a branch/jump mispredict or order mispredict, among others, the journal (i.e., reorder buffer) may be read backwards, that is, in an order that is reverse relative to an order used for writing the journal. The journal is read backwards such that all of the state changes caused by mapping instructions subsequent to the exception (referred to interchangeably herein as “bad path” instructions) get unwound (e.g., undone or unrolled) as state changes caused by mapping those instructions are back-out, in an order that is reverse from an order in which they were applied.

(19) For example, in an event a memory system (not shown) of the OoO processor determines that it cannot service a given instruction and, thus, takes an exception, the OoO processor unwinds subsequent instructions that followed the given instruction. Even though the subsequent instructions followed the given instruction in a program order generated by a compiler, the OoO processor started working on those subsequent instructions before the given instruction because the OoO processor is capable of executing instructions out-of-order. Since a consequence of register renaming, that is, mapping ARs to PRs, is that a present state of AR-to-PR mappings is changed, dynamically, unwinding of those subsequent instructions includes reversing the state changes that were made due to the mapping in an order that is reverse from an order used to apply those state changes. The mapper may read and undo the state changes stored in the journal in reverse order in order to undo such changes and restore the state.

(20) To improve performance for such unwinding operations, the mapper periodically creates “snapshots,” that is, the mapper stores copies of a present state of the mapper, such as the present state of the integer mapper state **108** and the floating-point (FP) mapper state **110**, disclosed further below with reference to FIG. **1B**. When the exception occurs, the mapper skips to the nearest snapshot and then starts unwinding from there, as disclosed further below with reference to FIG. **1G**. Such snapshots may employ a significant amount of logic and hence power when being accessed/written to. To reduce such power, an example embodiment partitions mapper logic and state into integer and FP logic and state.

(21) A source or destination register for an instruction either uses either the integer or FP logic, but not both. According to an example embodiment, separate snapshots are maintained for integer and FP state, such as disclosed further below with regard to FIG. **1B**. During normal operation, both

portions of the mapper are in use. Every snapshot that occurs updates both pieces, that is, both the integer state and FP state are stored each time a snapshot is taken. While mapping instructions, it's noted (i.e., recorded) if an instruction that employs an FP AR as a destination has been seen. If no instruction has been seen, over a stretch of received instructions, that employs an FP AR as a destination, an example embodiment may determine that an FP snapshot, if performed, would be identical to a last FP snapshot that was performed.

(22) An example embodiment may determine that a long enough period has transpired, for example, based on a given number of instructions that have been mapped, during which no instruction has used an FP AR as a destination and, as such, it may be determined that all FP snapshots being maintained are identical. At this point, an example embodiment may stop writing to the FP snapshot upon mapping and may further ignore reading such snapshots during an unwinding operation. At some point an instruction using an FP AR as a destination may be encountered. Such an encounter may alter at least one FP present indicator, such as the at least one FP present indicator **112** of FIG. **1A**, disclosed below, causing FP snapshots to be updated once again while mapping instructions, such as disclosed further below with regard to FIG. **1B**, and to be used again during unwinding of instructions, such as disclosed further below with regard to FIG. **1G**.

(23) In a typical program executed by the OoO processor, there may be large stretches of code, that is, a large number of instructions, that do not employ FP instructions. As such, FP ARs used as destinations may be absent over large stretches of instructions. An example embodiment may record presence of FP ARs used as destinations in order to identify such large stretches in which FP ARs are not present and use such information to improve power efficiency of the OoO processor. Such information may be used during both mapping and unwinding operations to reduce access/writing to FP snapshot circuitry, such as the FP snapshot circuitry **116**, disclosed below with regard to FIG. **1A**, in order to improve power efficiency.

(24) FIG. **1A** is a block diagram of an example embodiment of a system **100** for mapping and unwinding instructions **104** in an out-of-order (OoO) processor (not shown). According to an example embodiment, the OoO processor may be a processor core of plurality of processor cores, such as a processor core of the plurality of processor cores **620a-k** of the network services processor **650** of FIG. **6**, disclosed further below.

(25) The system **100** comprises a mapper **102**. The mapper **102** is configured to use integer mapper state **108** (also referred to interchangeably herein as present integer mapper state **108**) and floating-point (FP) mapper state **110** (also referred to interchangeably herein as present FP mapper state **110**) for mapping the instructions **104** to produce the mapped instructions **106**. The mapper **102** maps the instructions **104** by mapping integer and FP architectural registers (ARs) (not shown) of the instructions **104** to integer and FP physical registers (PRs) (not shown) of the OoO processor. The mapper **102** is configured to record, via the at least one FP present indicator **112**, presence of FP architectural registers (ARs) (not shown) used as destinations (not shown) in the instructions **104**.

(26) Mapping an architectural register (AR) that is used as a destination register in an instruction changes mapper state, in general. For example, mapping an integer AR that is used as a destination in the instruction causes the integer mapper state **108** to change, as disclosed further below. Similarly, mapping an FP AR that is used as a destination in the instruction causes the FP mapper state **110** to change, as disclosed further below. As such, the integer mapper state **108** and FP mapper state **110** change, dynamically, as the mapper **102** is parsing the instructions **104**. According to an example embodiment, each of the instructions **104** is associated with a respective mapper identifier (ID) that is unique. The respective mapper ID is also associated with a given entry of a journal, such as the journal **130** of FIG. **1E** or the journal **130** of FIG. **1F**, disclosed further below. The given entry indicates whether a change was made to the integer mapper state **108** or FP mapper state **110** as a result of mapping a respective instruction. The respective mapper

ID identifies a given location in the journal that is associated with the respective instruction, that is, the respective mapper ID identifies the given entry that can be used to unwind (i.e., undo or unroll) any state change(s) included in the given entry should an exception be triggered causing same.

(27) The system **100** comprises integer snapshot circuitry **114** and FP snapshot circuitry **116** configured to store integer snapshots **131a-m** and FP snapshots **135a-m** of the integer mapper state **108** and FP mapper state **110**, respectively. Such snapshots represent the integer mapper state **108** and FP mapper state **110** captured at points in time. The mapper **102** is configured to use the snapshots to expedite restoration of the integer mapper state **108** and FP mapper state **110** to former respective states, as disclosed further below with regard to FIG. 1G, in an event a restart event (not shown) transpires.

(28) By advantageously selecting a given integer snapshot from among the stored integer snapshots **131a-m**, the mapper **102** can skip to a particular earlier state of the integer mapper state **108** that was present earlier and needs a least number of integer state changes to be restored to a particular former integer mapper state (not shown). The mapper **102** uses the given integer snapshot to expedite the restoration relative to restoring the integer mapper state **108** back to the former integer mapper state, directly. For example, instead of applying integer state changes to the integer mapper state **108**, directly, the mapper **102** may copy the given integer snapshot to the integer mapper state **108** to skip to the earlier state and then apply a number of integer state changes that are less relative to another number of integer state changes that would need to be applied to the integer mapper state **108**, directly, in order to restore the integer mapper state **108** to the former integer mapper state.

(29) The least number of state changes are least in number relative to a total number of state changes that would need to be applied to any of the other stored integer snapshots in order to restore the integer mapper state **108** back to the former integer mapper state. The former integer mapper state represents the integer mapper state **108** at a point in time before a sequence of integer mapper state changes (not shown) were applied thereto. The sequence of integer mapper state changes was applied as a result of mapping instructions subsequent to the instruction causing the restart event.

(30) Reversing the sequence of integer mapper state changes “unwinds” the instructions that were mapped, resulting in same. Reversing the sequence unrolls the state changes caused by mapping the instructions, that is, the bad-path instructions that were executed before the instruction earlier in the program order was executed and caused the restart event. Unwinding an instruction reverses any effect on the system **100** that was caused by mapping and executing the instruction. Instructions that are eligible for unwinding are those instructions that are “in-flight” instructions, that is, instructions that have been mapped by the OoO processor but not yet retired by the OoO processor.

(31) The mapper **102** uses the integer mapper state **108** for mapping integer ARs in the instructions **104** and uses the FP mapper state **110** for mapping FP ARs in the instructions **104**. As such, similar to selecting and using a given integer snapshot of the integer mapper state **108** to expedite unwinding, the mapper **102** advantageously selects a given FP snapshot from among the stored FP snapshots **135a-m** to expedite restoration of the FP mapper state **110** to a former FP mapper state (not shown) in an event the restart event transpires. The given FP snapshot that is selected may enable the mapper **102** to skip to a particular FP state of the FP mapper state **110** that needs a least number of FP state changes to be restored to the former FP mapper state.

(32) To capture the integer snapshots **131a-m** in the integer snapshot circuitry **114** and the FP snapshots **135a-m** in the FP snapshot circuitry **116**, the mapper **102** may be further configured to write to the integer snapshot circuitry **114** and FP snapshot circuitry **116**, periodically. In order to restore the integer mapper state **108** and FP mapper state **110** to a former integer mapper state and former FP mapper state, respectively, the mapper **102** may be further configured to read from the integer snapshot circuitry **114** and FP snapshot circuitry **116** responsive to a restart event. The restart event causes at least one instruction to be unwound (e.g., undone), that is, any effect on the system **100** that was caused as a result of mapping and, possibly, executing the at least one

instruction is reversed.

(33) As disclosed above, in a typical program executed by the OoO processor, there may be large stretches of code that do not employ FP instructions. As such, FP ARs used as destinations may be absent over large stretches of instructions. By using the at least one FP present indicator **112** to record presence of the FP ARs used as destinations, the mapper **102** can advantageously track when changes to the FP mapper state **110** occur. The mapper **102** may use the at least one FP present indicator **112** to determine whether the FP snapshots **135a-m** in the FP snapshot circuitry **116** are identical to the FP mapper state **110**. To improve power efficiency of the OoO processor, as disclosed further below, the mapper **102** may avoid reading and writing to the FP snapshot circuitry **116** based on such knowledge.

(34) For example, the mapper **102** may be blocked, intermittently, as a function of the at least one FP present indicator **112**, from writing to and reading from the FP snapshot circuitry **116**. Such blocking may be performed in any suitable way that prevents the FP snapshot circuitry **116** from being read from or written to. For example, the block **127** may be performed via block logic (not shown) that disables a particular clock(s) used for reading and writing the FP snapshot circuitry **116**. Alternatively, the mapper **102** may be configured to read a value(s) of the at least one FP present indicator **112** and refrain from reading and writing the FP snapshot circuitry **116** based on the value(s) read.

(35) To write to the integer snapshot circuitry **114** and the FP snapshot circuitry **116**, the mapper **102** may be further configured to copy the integer mapper state **108** to a given integer snapshot of the integer snapshots **131a-m** and to copy the FP mapper state **110** to a given FP snapshot of the FP snapshots **135a-m**. To read from the integer snapshot circuitry **114** and FP snapshot circuitry **116**, the mapper **102** may be further configured to copy a given integer snapshot of the integer snapshots **131a-m** to the integer mapper state **108** and to copy a given FP snapshot of the FP snapshots **135a-m** to the FP mapper state **110**.

(36) It should be understood that such a write/copy operation may be performed in any suitable manner that enables a present state of the integer mapper state **108** to be stored in the integer snapshot circuitry **114** and enables a present state of the FP mapper state **110** to be stored in the FP snapshot circuitry **116**. For example, copy logic may be triggered that latches the integer mapper state **108** in a given arrangement of circuitry, that is, a given integer snapshot of the integer snapshots **131a-m** of the integer snapshot circuitry **114**, and latches the FP mapper state **110** in another given arrangement of circuitry, that is, a given FP snapshot of the FP snapshots **135a-m** of the FP snapshot circuitry **116**.

(37) Similarly, it should be understood that such a read/copy operation may be performed in any suitable manner that causes a given integer snapshot of the integer snapshots **131a-m** of the integer snapshot circuitry **114** to be transferred to the integer mapper state **108** and causes a given FP snapshot of the FP snapshots **135a-m** of the FP snapshot circuitry **116** to be transferred to the FP mapper state **110**. The read/copy operation may be employed for unwinding instructions, such as disclosed further below with regard to FIG. **1G**, and the write/copy operation may be employed for mapping instructions, such as disclosed further below with regard to FIG. **1B**.

(38) By using the at least one FP present indicator **112** to refrain from copying the FP snapshot circuitry **116** to a given FP snapshot of FP snapshots **135a-m**, and vice versa, at times when such copying is unnecessary because the FP mapper state **110** and each of the FP snapshots **135a-m** are identical, power savings is achieved. Such savings may be considered substantial and is per-processor. According to an example embodiment, the OoO processor may be a processor core of plurality of processor cores, such as a processor core of the plurality of processor cores **620a-k** of the network services processor **650** of FIG. **6**, disclosed further below. As such, power savings is achieved for each processor core of the plurality of processor cores **620a-k**. According to an example embodiment, a total number of the plurality of processor cores **620a-k** may be 24; however, the total number is not limited to 24. As disclosed with regard to FIG. **1B**, below, copying

to the FP snapshot circuitry **116** to expedite unwinding may be advantageously blocked, as a function of the at least one FP present indicator **112**, during mapping of instructions to realize a portion of such savings in power.

(39) FIG. **1B** is a block diagram of an example embodiment of the system **100** of FIG. **1A**. In the example embodiment, the system **100** is used for instruction mapping in the OoO processor. The system **100** receives the instructions **104** that may be instructions generated, originally, by a compiler (not shown), fetched from an instruction cache (not shown) and subsequently decoded by a decoder (not shown) for transmission to the mapper **102**. The mapper **102** is configured to map the instructions **104** to produce the mapped instructions **106** for execution by an execution unit (not shown) of the OoO processor. The mapped instructions **106** may be considered to be in-flight instructions until such instructions have been both executed and completed by the OoO processor, at which point the mapped instructions **106** and, thus, the instructions **104**, may be retired. It should be understood that it is possible for an instruction to be executed and retired without completion, for example, due to a branch misprediction or other exception event.

(40) The mapper **102** is configured to map the instructions **104** by mapping integer architectural registers (ARs) (not shown) and floating-point (FP) ARs (not shown) of the instructions **104** to integer physical registers (PRs) (not shown) and FP PRs (not shown) of the OoO processor, respectively, based on integer mapper state **108** and FP mapper state **110** of the mapper **102**, respectively. The mapper **102** is further configured to record, via the at least one FP present indicator **112**, presence of FP ARs used as destinations in the instructions **104**. The system **100** further comprises the integer snapshot circuitry **114** and FP snapshot circuitry **116**.

(41) The mapper **102** is further configured to copy, periodically, the integer mapper state **108** to the integer snapshot circuitry **114** and to copy, intermittently, based on the at least one FP present indicator **112**, the FP mapper state **110** to the FP snapshot circuitry **116**. Copying to the at least FP snapshot circuitry **116** is intermittent as such copying may be blocked, intermittently, as disclosed above, based on the at least one FP present indicator **112**. Such blocking may be performed in an event the mapper **102** recognizes, via the at least one FP present indicator **112**, that FP snapshots, such as the FP snapshots **135a-m** of FIG. **1A**, disclosed above, that are snapshots of the FP mapper state **110** stored in the FP snapshot circuitry **116**, are identical to the FP mapper state **110**.

(42) The integer snapshot circuitry **114** may include an arrangement of flip-flops or any other combination of circuitry that may be employed to store/restore state of the integer mapper state **108** in a single cycle. Likewise, the FP snapshot circuitry **116** may include an arrangement of flip-flops or any other combination of circuitry that may be employed to store/restore state of the FP mapper state **110** in a single cycle.

(43) The system **100** further comprises an integer-register mapper table (not shown) and an integer physical register (PR) free list (not shown), such as disclosed below with reference to FIG. **1C**. The integer mapper state **108** represents the integer-register mapper table in its present state and the integer-PR free list in its present state. Presence of an integer AR used as a destination register in an instruction causes a change to the integer-register mapper table and the integer-PR free list, as disclosed further below. As such, presence of an integer AR used as a destination register in an instruction causes a change to the integer mapper state **108**, as disclosed below.

(44) FIG. **1C** is a block diagram of an example embodiment of an integer-register mapper table **121** and an integer-PR free list **118** that may be employed in the system **100**. The integer mapper state **108** disclosed above with reference to FIG. **1B**, may represent the integer-register mapper table **121** in its present state and the integer-PR free list **118** in its present state.

(45) With reference to FIG. **1B** and FIG. **1C**, to map the instructions **104**, the mapper **102** may be further configured, for each instruction, to determine whether the instruction includes at least one instance of an integer AR used as a source. In an event the instruction includes the at least one instance, the mapper **102** may be further configured to use the integer-register mapper table **121** to map a respective integer AR of each instance of the at least one instance to a respective integer PR

of the integer PRs **120** of the OoO processor. As such, no change is made to either the integer-register mapper table **121** or the integer-PR free list **118** and, thus, no change is made to the integer mapper state **108** for mapping integer ARs used as sources in the instructions **104**.

(46) According to the example embodiment of FIG. **1C**, the integer-register mapper table **121** is a lookup table (LUT) that includes a plurality of entries, namely, entry.sub.0-entry.sub.i. Each entry of the plurality of entries entry.sub.0-entry.sub.i of the LUT, that is, the integer-register mapper table **121**, is indexed via a unique integer architectural register (AR) of a plurality of integer ARs **119** of the OoO processor, namely integer AR.sub.0-AR.sub.i, to retrieve content stored in the respective entry. It should be understood that indexing via the unique integer AR may be performed via a unique identifier thereof.

(47) Each entry of the plurality of entries of the integer-register mapper table **121**, namely entry.sub.0-entry.sub.i, is configured to reference a unique integer PR of the integer PRs **120** of the OoO processor (not shown). Such referencing may be performed by storing a unique identifier of the respective integer PR in the respective entry. As such, the integer-register mapper table **121** may be indexed by the mapper **102** of FIG. **1B** via a given integer AR of the plurality of integer ARs **119** to retrieve a given integer PR of the integer PRs **120**, wherein the given integer AR is mapped to the given integer PR.

(48) As such, the integer-register mapper table **121** is configured to store mappings between the plurality of integer ARs **119** and a set of integer PRs of the integer PRs **120**. According to an example embodiment, the mapper **102** of FIG. **1B** may be configured to initialize each entry of the plurality of entries entry.sub.0-entry.sub.i of the integer-register mapper table **121** to reference respective unique integer PRs (e.g., integer PR.sub.0-PR.sub.i) of the integer PRs **120**.

(49) For example, a total number of integer ARs may be 36 and a total number of integer PRs may be 128. As such, the integer-register mapper table **121** may be initialized to map integer AR.sub.0 through integer AR.sub.35 to integer PR.sub.0 through integer PR.sub.35, respectively. Initialization may map such registers in consecutive order, for example, by mapping integer AR.sub.0 to integer PR.sub.0, integer AR.sub.1 to integer PR.sub.1, etc. It should be understood, however, that such mapping need not map the registers in consecutive order.

(50) It should be understood that a total number of the plurality of integer ARs **119** may be less than a total number of the integer PRs **120** and, as such, a given number of integer PRs of the integer PRs **120** may not be mapped to respective integer ARs and may be referred to interchangeably herein as “unmapped” integer PRs or “free” integer PRs. The integer-PR free list **118** is configured to identify such free integer PRs, that is, the unmapped integer PRs. The integer-PR free list **118** may be implemented in any suitable way that identifies the unmapped integer PRs.

(51) For example, the integer-PR free list **118** may be a memory with multiple entries used to store a listing of free integer PRs by storing identifiers of the free integer PRs in the entries.

Alternatively, the integer-PR free list **118** may be a memory that is configured to store a vector(s) with bits corresponding to the integer PRs **120**. The mapper **102** of FIG. **1B** may be configured to configure a given bit corresponding to a given integer PR in the vector based on whether the given integer PR is free or mapped to a given integer AR. According to an example embodiment, the OoO processor may include 128 integer PRs. As such, the integer-PR free list **118** may be a 128-bit vector. It should be understood that a total number of integer PRs is not limited to 128 and that the integer-PR free list **118** is not limited to a 128-bit vector.

(52) It should be understood that a total number i of the plurality of integer ARs **119** may be any total number of integer ARs that is supported by the OoO processor. Referring back to FIG. **1B**, the integer ARs (not shown) of the instructions **104** are from among the plurality of integer ARs **119** of the OoO processor that may be used to index the integer-register mapper table **121**, as disclosed above with regard to FIG. **1C**.

(53) The mapper **102** is further configured, for each instruction, to determine whether the instruction includes at least one instance of an integer AR used as a destination. For each at least

one instance, the mapper **102** changes the integer mapper state **108** and stores information regarding the change in an entry of a journal, such as disclosed below with regard to FIG. **1E**. For each at least one instance, the mapper **102** removes a free integer PR from the integer-PR free list **118** and changes a present mapping for the integer AR in the integer-register mapper table **121** such that the integer AR is mapped to the free integer PR. As such, both the integer-register mapper table **121** and integer-PR free list **118** are modified based on each at least one instance causing the integer mapper state **108** to change. As disclosed above, the integer mapper state **108** represents the integer-register mapper table **121** and integer-PR free list **118** in their respective present states. Thus, any change to the integer-register mapper table **121** or integer-PR free list **118** causes a change in state of the integer mapper state **108**.

(54) As disclosed above, the mapper **102** employs the integer-register mapper table **121** to map integer ARs used as sources in the instructions and uses a combination of the integer-register mapper table **121** and integer-PR free list **118** to map integer ARs used as destinations in the instructions **104**. The system **100** further comprises an FP-register mapper table and an FP physical register (PR) free list, such as disclosed below with reference to FIG. **1D**.

(55) The FP mapper state **110** may represent the FP-register mapper table in its present state and the FP-PR free list in its present state. Presence of an FP AR used as a destination register in an instruction causes a change to the FP-register mapper table and the FP-PR free list, as disclosed further below. As such, presence of an FP AR used as a destination register in an instruction causes a change to the FP mapper state **110**, as disclosed below with regard to FIG. **1D**.

(56) FIG. **1D** is a block diagram of an example embodiment of an FP-register mapper table and an FP-PR free list that may be employed in the system **100**. The FP mapper state **110** disclosed above with reference to FIG. **1B**, may represent the FP-register mapper table **122** in its present state and the FP-PR free list **124** in its present state.

(57) With reference to FIG. **1B** and FIG. **1D**, to map the instructions **104**, the mapper **102** may be further configured, for each instruction, to determine whether the instruction includes at least one instance of an FP AR used as a source. In an event the instruction includes the at least one instance, the mapper **102** may be further configured to use the FP-register mapper table **122** to map a respective integer AR of each instance of the at least one instance to a respective FP PR of the FP PRs **126** of the OoO processor. As such, no change is made to either the FP-register mapper table **122** or the FP-PR free list **124** and, thus, no change is made to the FP mapper state **110** for mapping FP ARs used as sources in the instructions **104**.

(58) According to the example embodiment of FIG. **1D**, the FP-register mapper table **122** is a lookup table (LUT) that includes a plurality of entries, namely, entry.sub.0-entry.sub.j. Each entry of the plurality of entries entry.sub.0-entry.sub.j of the LUT, that is, the FP-register mapper table **122**, is indexed via a unique AR of a plurality of FP ARs **125** of the OoO processor, namely FP AR.sub.0-AR.sub.j, to retrieve content stored in the respective entry. It should be understood that indexing via the unique FP AR may be performed via a unique identifier thereof. According to an example embodiment, a number of the plurality of FP ARs **125** may be 32 while a number of the plurality of integer ARs **119**, disclosed above with regard to FIG. **1C**, may be 36. It should be understood, however, that the number of the plurality of integer ARs **119** and the number of the plurality of FP ARs **125** is not limited to 36 and 32, respectively. It should also be understood that the integer-register mapper table **121** of FIG. **1C**, disclosed above, and the FP-register mapper table **122** of FIG. **1D** may be implemented as a single table that is hierarchically subdivided.

(59) Each entry of the plurality of entries of the FP-register mapper table **122**, namely entry.sub.0-entry.sub.j, is configured to reference a unique FP PR of the FP PRs **126** of the OoO processor (not shown). Such referencing may be performed by storing a unique identifier of the respective FP PR in the respective entry. As such, the FP-register mapper table **122** may be indexed by the mapper **102** of FIG. **1B** via a given FP AR of the plurality of FP ARs **125** to retrieve a given FP PR of the FP PRs **126**, wherein the given FP AR is mapped to the given FP PR. As such, the FP-register

mapper table **122** is configured to store mappings between the plurality of FP ARs **125** and a set of FP PRs of the FP PRs **126**. According to an example embodiment, the mapper **102** of FIG. **1B** may be configured to initialize each entry of the plurality of entries entry.sub.0-entry.sub.j of the FP-register mapper table **122** to reference respective unique FP PRs (e.g., FP PR.sub.0-PR.sub.j) of the FP PRs **126**.

(60) For example, a total number of FP ARs may be 32 and a total number of FP PRs may be 96. As such, the FP-register mapper table **122** may be initialized to map FP AR.sub.0 through FP AR.sub.31 to FP PR.sub.0 through PR.sub.31, respectively. Initialization may map such registers in consecutive order, for example, by mapping FP AR.sub.0 to FP PR.sub.0, FP AR.sub.1 to FP PR.sub.1, etc. It should be understood, however, that such mapping need not map the registers in consecutive order.

(61) It should be understood that a total number of the plurality of FP ARs **125** may be less than a total number of the FP PRs **126** and, as such, a given number of FP PRs of the FP PRs **126** may not be mapped to respective FP ARs and may be referred to interchangeably herein as “unmapped” FP PRs or “free” FP PRs. The FP-PR free list **124** is configured to identify free FP PRs (not shown), that is, unmapped FP PRs (not shown). The FP-PR free list **124** may be implemented in any suitable way.

(62) For example, the FP-PR free list **124** may be a memory with multiple entries to store a listing of free FP PRs by storing identifiers of the free FP PRs in the entries. Alternatively, the FP-PR free list **124** may be a memory that is configured to store a vector(s) with bits corresponding to the FP PRs **126**. The mapper **102** of FIG. **1B** may be configured to configure a given bit corresponding to a given FP PR in the vector based on whether the given FP PR is free or mapped to a given FP AR. According to an example embodiment, the OoO processor may include 96 FP physical registers. As such, the FP-PR free list **124** may be a 96-bit vector. It should be understood that a total number of FP physical registers is not limited to 96 and that the FP-PR free list **124** is not limited to a 96-bit vector.

(63) It should be understood that a total number j of the plurality of FP ARs **125** may be any total number of FP ARs that is supported by the OoO processor. Referring back to FIG. **1B**, the FP ARs (not shown) of the instructions **104** are from among the plurality of FP ARs **125** of the OoO processor that may be used to index the FP-register mapper table **122**. The mapper **102** is further configured, for each instruction of the instructions **104**, to determine whether the instruction includes at least one instance of an FP AR used as a destination.

(64) If there is at least one instance of an FP AR used as a destination, the mapper **102** records same via the at least one FP indicator **112**, as disclosed further below. For each at least one instance, the mapper **102** changes the FP mapper state **110** and stores information regarding the change in an entry of a journal, such as disclosed below with regard to FIG. **1E**. For each at least one instance, the mapper **102** removes a free FP PR from the FP-PR free list **124** and changes a present mapping for the FP AR in the FP-register mapper table **122** such that the FP AR is mapped to the free FP PR. As such, both the FP-register mapper table **122** and FP-PR free list **124** are modified based on each at least one instance causing the FP mapper state **110** to change. As disclosed above, the FP mapper state **110** represents the FP-register mapper table **122** and FP-PR free list **124** in their respective present states. Thus, any change to the FP-register mapper table **122** or FP-PR free list **124** causes a change in state of the FP mapper state **110**.

(65) As disclosed above, the mapper **102** employs the FP-register mapper table **122** to map FP ARs used as sources in the instructions and uses a combination of the FP-register mapper table **122** and FP-PR free list **124** to map FP ARs used as destinations in the instructions **104**. As disclosed above, a journal may be used to record change(s) or lack thereof that are made to the integer mapper state **108** or FP mapper state **110** by the mapper **102** for mapping the instructions **104**. The mapper **102** may be further configured to write a respective entry (not shown) to the journal for each instruction of the instructions **104**, such as disclosed below with regard to FIG. **1E**.

(66) FIG. 1E is a block diagram of an example embodiment of a journal **130**, integer snapshot circuitry **114**, and FP snapshot circuitry **116** that may be employed in the system **100**. To map the instructions, the mapper **102** may be further configured, for each instruction, to write an entry to the journal **130** for the instruction. The entry may be associated with a mapper identifier that is also associated with the instruction. Content of the entry may represent an effect or lack thereof on the integer mapper state **108** or FP mapper state **110** that resulted from mapping of the instruction by the mapper **102**. Such content may be used for unwinding instructions as disclosed below with regard to FIG. 1G. As disclosed above with reference to FIG. 1C, no change is made to the integer mapper state **108** for mapping integer ARs used as sources in the instructions **104** and, as disclosed above with reference to FIG. 1D, no change is made to the FP mapper state **110** for mapping FP ARs used as sources in the instructions **104**.

(67) According to an example embodiment, the mapper **102** may be further configured to map a given number of instructions, also referred to interchangeably herein as a bundle, on a cycle-by-cycle basis, and to write at least one entry, of the given number, to the journal **130**, on the cycle-by-cycle basis. According to an example embodiment, the given number, that is, a size of the bundle, may be four. As such, in a given cycle, the mapper **102** may consult the integer mapper state **108**, FP mapper state **110**, or a combination thereof, 4 times in a given cycle and write 4 entries to the journal **130** in a given cycle.

(68) In an event an actual number of instructions received in a cycle is less than the given number, the mapper **102** may be further configured to write the at least one entry, of the given number, to the journal **130** and, in at least one respective entry of the at least one entry written, indicate via the content that the effect is no effect. A total number of the at least one respective entry, that is, those entries corresponding to instructions that were not received in the cycle, is a difference between the given number and the actual number. For example, if a bundle size is four, that is, if the given number is four, and three instructions are received in the cycle, the total number of entries written to the journal **130** is four; however, one entry is written to indicate via the content that the effect is no effect because the entry is not associated with a particular instruction that was mapped.

(69) The effect is also no effect in an event the instruction has no instance of either an integer or FP AR used as a destination. As such, mapper **102** may be further configured to indicate, via the content of the entry of the journal **130**, that no change to either the integer mapper state **108** or the FP mapper state **110** resulted from mapping the instruction. Such would be the case, for example, for cases in which an instruction did not include any AR, either integer or FP, that was used as a destination.

(70) In an event the instruction includes at least one instance of an integer AR used as a destination, the effect includes at least one change to the integer mapper state **108**. The mapper **102** may be further configured to include in the content of the entry written to the journal **130**, for each instance of the at least one instance, the integer AR (not shown), a present integer PR (not shown), and a next integer PR (not shown). For example, at a time of mapping the instruction, the integer-register mapper table **121**, in its present state at the time, includes a mapping between the integer AR and the present integer PR. Prior to mapping of the instruction, that is, preceding the mapping of the instruction, the next integer PR is a free integer PR included in the integer-PR free list **118**. To map the integer AR used as the destination, the mapper **102** removes that free integer PR from the integer-PR free list **118** and changes the mapping to be between the integer AR and a next integer PR, where the next integer PR is the free integer PR that was removed from the integer-PR free list **118**. As such, mapping the instruction causes the mapper **102** to map the integer AR of the instruction to the next integer PR.

(71) As such, both the integer-register mapper table **121** and the integer-PR free list **118** are changed based on the at least one instance of an integer AR used as a destination. Thus, the integer mapper state **108** is changed based on encountering at least one instance of an integer AR used as a destination in the instruction. In an event the mapper **102** is notified of completion of the

instruction by the OoO processor, the mapper **102** may be further configured to retire the entry from the journal **130** and add, based on the content, the present integer PR of each instance of the at least one instance to the integer-PR free list **118**.

(72) In an event the instruction includes at least one instance of an FP AR used as a destination, the effect includes at least one change to the FP mapper state **110**. The mapper **102** is further configured to update the at least one FP indicator **112** to record a presence of at least one FP AR in the instruction, and to include, in the content of the entry of the journal **130**, for each at least one instance, the FP AR (not shown), a present FP PR (not shown), and a next FP PR (not shown). For example, at a time of mapping the instruction, the FP-register mapper table **122**, in its present state at the time, includes a mapping between the FP AR and the present FP PR. Prior to mapping of the instruction, that is, preceding mapping of the instruction, the next FP PR is a free FP PR included in the FP-PR free list **124**. The mapper **102** is further configured to remove the free FP PR from the FP-PR free list **124** and change the mapping to be between the FP AR and a next FP PR, where the next FP PR is the free FP PR that was removed from the FP-PR free list **124**. As such, mapping the instruction causes the mapper **102** to map the FP AR of the instruction to the next FP PR. In an event the mapper **102** is notified of completion of the instruction by the OoO processor, the mapper **102** may be further configured to retire the entry from the journal **130** and add, based on the content, the present FP PR of each instance of the at least one instance to the FP-PR free list **124**.

(73) The journal **130** is partitioned into a plurality of sections that include the section **139a** through the section **139m**, with respective boundaries therebetween. With reference to FIGS. **1B** and **1E**, the mapper **102** may be configured to write a respective entry to the journal **130** for each instruction of the instructions **104**. The mapper **102** may be configured to copy the integer mapper state **108** to the integer snapshot circuitry **114**, periodically, responsive to a change (not shown) in sections of the journal **130** written to by the mapper **102**. The change is between consecutive sections. The mapper **102** may be configured to copy the FP mapper state **110** to the FP snapshot circuitry **116**, intermittently, based on the at least one FP present indicator **112** and the change in sections. Copying of the FP mapper state **110** may be intermittent as such copying may be blocked, intermittently, based on the at least one FP present indicator **112**.

(74) It should be understood that a total number of the sections **139a-m** of the journal **130** may be any number of sections. According to an example embodiment, the total number of the sections may be 4. According to an example embodiment, a total number of entries of the journal may be 128 and a total number of entries within each section may be 32.

(75) The journal **130** may be a circular buffer with a head pointer (not shown) and a tail pointer (not shown). As such, sections of the journal **130** wrap **133**, with a first section, that is, section **139a**, following a last section, that is, section **139m**, in the journal **130**. The mapper **102** may be further configured to detect the change in sections based on a modification made to the head pointer. For example, the head pointer may reference a present entry in the journal. To write a new entry to the journal **130**, that is, to add the new entry, the mapper **102** modifies the head pointer to reference the new entry in the journal **130**. The mapper **102** may detect the change in an event the present entry and the new entry are located in different sections of the journal **130**, in which case, the modification causes the head pointer to reference a different section from a previous section referenced immediately prior to the modification.

(76) As disclosed above, each entry of the journal **130** may be associated with a mapper ID that is also associated with a respective instruction that corresponds to the entry. As such, sections of the journal **130** may be associated with a respective set of mapper identifiers (IDs) and the mapper **102** may detect the change based on a respective mapper ID of an instruction that is being mapped.

(77) According to the example embodiment, the integer snapshot circuitry **114** includes a respective integer snapshot associated with each boundary between sections of the journal. Each integer snapshot includes a respective integer-register-map snapshot and respective integer-PR-free-list snapshot. For example, the integer snapshot circuitry **114** includes the integer snapshot **131a** that is

associated with the boundary **140a**, that is, a first boundary of the journal **130**. The integer snapshot **131a** includes the integer-register-map snapshot **132a** and the integer-PR-free-list snapshot **134a**. The integer snapshot circuitry **114** further includes the integer snapshot **131m** that is associated with the boundary **140m**, that is, a last boundary of the journal **130** and includes the integer-register-map snapshot **132m** and the integer-PR-free-list snapshot **134m**.

(78) Each respective integer-register-map snapshot, that is, each of the integer-register-map snapshots **132a-m**, includes a respective arrangement of circuitry (not shown) for storing a respective copy of the integer-register mapper table **121**, disclosed above with reference to FIG. **1C**. Each respective integer-PR free list, that is, each of the integer-PR-free-list snapshots **134a-m**, includes a respective arrangement of circuitry (not shown) for storing a respective copy of the integer-PR free list **118**, disclosed above with reference to FIG. **1C**.

(79) According to the example embodiment, the FP snapshot circuitry **116** includes a respective FP snapshot associated with each boundary between sections of the journal. Each FP snapshot includes a respective FP-register-map snapshot and respective FP-PR-free-list snapshot. For example, the FP snapshot circuitry **116** includes the FP snapshot **135a** that includes the FP-register-map snapshot **136a** and the FP-PR-free-list snapshot **138a** and is associated with the boundary **140a**, that is, a first boundary of the journal **130**. The FP snapshot circuitry **116** further includes the FP snapshot **135m** that includes the FP-register-map snapshot **136m** and the FP-PR-free-list snapshot **138m** and is associated with the boundary **140m**, that is, a last boundary of the journal **130**.

(80) Each respective FP-register-map snapshot, that is, each of the FP-register-map snapshots **136a-m**, includes a respective arrangement of circuitry (not shown) for storing a respective copy of the FP-register mapper table **122**, disclosed above with reference to FIG. **1D**. Each respective FP-PR free list, that is, each of the FP-PR-free-list snapshots **138a-m**, includes a respective arrangement of circuitry (not shown) for storing a respective copy of the FP-PR free list **124**, disclosed above with reference to FIG. **1D**.

(81) Referring to FIGS. **1B**, **1C**, and **1E**, to copy the integer mapper state **108** to the integer snapshot circuitry **114**, the mapper **102** may be further configured to copy, in response to the change in sections of the journal **130**, (i) the integer-register mapper table **121** to a given integer-register-map snapshot of the plurality of integer-register-map snapshots **132a-m** included in the integer snapshot circuitry **114** and (ii) the integer-PR free list **118** to a given integer-PR-free-list snapshot of the plurality of integer-PR-free-list snapshots **134a-m** included in the integer snapshot circuitry **114**. The given integer-register-map snapshot and the given integer-PR-free-list snapshot are associated with a given boundary of the respective boundaries. The given boundary is crossed based on the change.

(82) For example, in an event the change is from the last section, that is, the section **139m**, to the first section, that is, the section **139a**, the given boundary is the boundary **140m**. As such, the given integer-register-map snapshot is the integer-register-map snapshot **132m** and the given integer-PR-free-list snapshot is the integer-PR-free-list snapshot **134m** that are both associated with the boundary **140m**. In response to the change, the mapper **102** copies the integer-register mapper table **121** to the integer-register-map snapshot **132m** and copies the integer-PR free list **118** to the integer-PR-free-list snapshot **134m**.

(83) Further, in an event copying of the FP mapper state **110** to the FP snapshot circuit **116** is enabled based on the at least one FP present indicator **112**, the mapper **102** may be further configured to copy, in response to the change, (i) the FP-register mapper table **122** to a given FP-register-map snapshot of the plurality of FP-register-map snapshots **136a-m** included in the FP snapshot circuitry **116** and (ii) the FP-PR free list **124** to a given FP-PR-free-list snapshot of the plurality of FP-PR-free-list snapshots **138a-m** included in the FP snapshot circuitry **116**. The given FP-register-map snapshot and the given FP-PR-free-list snapshot are associated with the given boundary that is crossed based on the change.

(84) As such, continuing with the example, the given FP-register-map snapshot is the FP-register-

map snapshot **136m** and the given FP-PR-free-list snapshot is the FP-PR-free-list snapshot **138m** that are both associated with the boundary **140m**. It should be understood that the foregoing example is for illustrative purposes and that any boundary between sections of the journal **130** may be crossed due to the change and, thus, the given integer and FP register map and free list snapshots that are employed for the copying may be different, based on which boundary is crossed.

(85) According to an example embodiment, the at least one FP present indicator **112** may include a plurality of FP present indicators. Alternatively, a counter may be employed as the at least one FP present indicator as disclosed, further below. In an event the at least one FP present indicator **112** includes the plurality of FP present indicators, each FP present indicator of the plurality of FP present indicators may be associated, on a one-to-one basis, with a respective section of the plurality of sections of the journal **130**, such as disclosed below with regard to FIG. **1F**.

(86) FIG. **1F** is a block diagram of an example embodiment of the at least one FP present indicator **112** that may be employed in the system **100** of FIG. **1B**, disclosed above. In the example embodiment of FIG. **1F**, the at least one FP present indicator includes a plurality of FP present indicators, namely the FP present indicator **112a**, FP present indicator **112b**, FP present indicator **112c**, and FP present indicator **112d**. A given FP present indicator of the plurality of FP present indicators is associated with a given section and represents whether there is at least one instruction associated with an entry in that section that uses an FP AR as a destination. As such, each FP present indicator may be used to indicate whether an FP AR has been used over a span of a given number of instructions. For example, if a section of the journal **130** includes 32 entries and the FP present indicator for that section is clear, then it is understood that no FP AR has been used as a destination over the span of 32 instructions associated with those 32 entries.

(87) It should be understood that for an FP present indicator to be “clear,” the FP present indicator may have a value of zero, and that for the FP present indicator to be “set,” the FP present indicator may have a value that is non-zero. It should be understood, however, that other values may be used to designate whether the FP present indicator is clear or set so long as such value are different relative to one another.

(88) Each FP present indicator, that is, each of the FP present indicators **112a-d**, is associated, on a one-to-one basis, with a respective section of the plurality of sections, namely the sections **139a-d** of the journal **130**. As such, since the journal **130** is partitioned into four sections, there are four FP present indicators in the example embodiment.

(89) It should be understood that a number of sections of the journal **130** is not limited to four and, thus, a number of the FP present indicators is not limited to four. Since the number of sections of the journal **130** is four in the example embodiment, there are four boundaries therebetween, namely, the boundary **140a**, the boundary **140b**, the boundary **140c**, and the boundary **140d**.

(90) In the example embodiment, the integer snapshot circuitry **114** includes circuitry for storing four integer snapshots of the integer mapper state **108**, namely a first integer snapshot **131a**, second integer snapshot **131b**, third integer snapshot **131c**, and fourth integer snapshot **131d**. Each integer snapshot includes circuitry for storing a respective pairing of an integer register snapshot and integer-PR-free-list snapshot associated with a respective boundary.

(91) For example, in the example embodiment, the integer snapshot circuitry **114** includes the integer-register-map snapshot **132a** and the integer-PR-free-list snapshot **134a** that are both associated with the boundary **140a**. The integer snapshot circuitry **114** includes the integer-register-map snapshot **132b** and the integer-PR-free-list snapshot **134b** that are both associated with the boundary **140b**. The integer snapshot circuitry **114** includes the integer-register-map snapshot **132c** and the integer-PR-free-list snapshot **134c** that are both associated with the boundary **140c**. The integer snapshot circuitry **114** includes the integer-register-map snapshot **132d** and the integer-PR-free-list snapshot **134d** that are both associated with the boundary **140d**.

(92) Similarly, the FP snapshot circuitry **116** includes circuitry for storing four FP snapshots of the FP mapper state **110**, namely a first FP snapshot **135a**, second FP snapshot **135b**, third FP snapshot

135c, and fourth FP snapshot **135d**. Each FP snapshot includes a respective pairing of an FP register snapshot and FP-PR-free-list snapshot associated with a respective boundary. For example, in the example embodiment, the FP snapshot circuitry **116** includes the FP-register-map snapshot **136a** and the FP-PR-free-list snapshot **138a** that are both associated with the boundary **140a**. The FP snapshot circuitry **116** includes the FP-register-map snapshot **136b** and the FP-PR-free-list snapshot **138b** that are both associated with the boundary **140b**. The FP snapshot circuitry **116** includes the FP-register-map snapshot **136c** and FP-PR-free-list snapshot **138c** that are both associated with the boundary **140c**. The FP snapshot circuitry **116** includes the FP-register-map snapshot **136d** and the FP-PR-free-list snapshot **138d** that are both associated with the boundary **140d**.

(93) To copy the integer mapper state **108** to the integer snapshot circuitry **114**, the mapper **102** may be further configured to copy, in response to the change in sections of the journal **130**, (i) the integer-register mapper table **121** to a given integer-register-map snapshot of the plurality of integer-register-map snapshots **132a-d** included in the integer snapshot circuitry **114** and (ii) the integer-PR free list **118** to a given integer-PR-free-list snapshot of the plurality of integer-PR-free-list snapshots **134a-d** included in the integer snapshot circuitry **114**.

(94) The given integer-register-map snapshot and the given integer-PR-free-list snapshot employed in the copying are the respective snapshots that are associated with the given boundary that is crossed based on the change. As such, the mapper **102** is configured to copy, periodically, the integer mapper state **108** to the integer snapshot circuitry **114**, that is, each time there is a change in sections of the journal **130** that is written to by the mapper **102**. As disclosed above and in further detail further below, the mapper **102** writes an entry to the journal **130** for each instruction of the instructions **104** that are mapped and, as a result, changes sections of the journal **130** each time a section is filled.

(95) In contrast to copying the integer mapper state **108**, periodically, in response to the change in sections of the journal **130**, the mapper **102** may copy the FP mapper state **110** intermittently, based on the change and the plurality of FP present indicators **112a-d**, namely, the FP present indicators **112a-d**. Such copying may be intermittent because, while a section may be filled and a change in sections occurs, copy to the FP snapshot circuitry **116** may be blocked in an event there is a single FP present indicator of the plurality of FP present indicators **112a-d** that is set.

(96) According to an example embodiment, each FP present indicator of the plurality of FP present indicators may be initialized to be set. For example, example each FP present indicator of the plurality of FP present indicators **112a-d** may be initialized to be set. For example, each FP present indicator of the plurality of FP present indicators **112a-d** may be initialized with a value of one. It should be understood that an FP present indicator that is “set” is not limited to having its value be one and that an FP present indicator that is “clear” is not limited to having its value be zero. Such values of one and zero are used for illustrative purpose. While each FP present indicator is initialized to be set, values for the FP present indicators may be altered by the mapper **102**, as disclosed in detail further below, thereby controlling whether or not copying of the FP mapper state **110** to the FP snapshot circuit **116** is enabled or blocked.

(97) In an event copying of the FP mapper state **110** to the FP snapshot circuit **116** is enabled based on the FP present indicators **112a-d**, the mapper **102** is further configured to copy, in response to the change, (i) the FP-register mapper table **122** to a given FP-register-map snapshot of the plurality of FP-register-map snapshots **136a-d** included in the FP snapshot circuitry **116** and (ii) the FP-PR free list **124** to a given FP-PR-free-list snapshot of the plurality of FP-PR-free-list snapshots **138a-d** included in the FP snapshot circuitry **116**. The given FP-register-map snapshot and the given FP-PR-free-list snapshot are the respective snapshots that are associated with the given boundary, namely, the boundary **140a**, boundary **140b**, boundary **140c**, or boundary **140d**, that is crossed based on the change.

(98) The mapper **102** is configured to read each FP present indicator of the plurality of FP present

indicators in response to the change. As such, in response to crossing any of the boundaries **140a-d**, the mapper **102** reads each of the FP present indicators **112a-d**. In an event each FP present indicator of the FP present indicators **112a-d** is clear, the mapper is configured to disable copying of the FP mapper state **110** to the FP snapshot circuitry **116**.

(99) In the event that each FP present indicator of the FP present indicators **112a-d** is clear, it is understood that such a copy is unnecessary because the copy would not change the FP mapper state **110** that is presently stored in the FP snapshot circuitry **116**. Such an understanding is based on an observation that no FP ARs have been used as destinations in the instructions **104** over a given number of the instructions. Presence of FP ARs used as destinations in the instructions **104** causes the FP mapper state **110** to change, as disclosed in detail, further below.

(100) In an event at least a single FP present indicator of the FP present indicators **112a-d** is set, the mapper **102** is configured to copy, in response to the change, the FP mapper state **110** to the FP snapshot circuitry **116** in addition to copying the integer mapper state **108** to the integer snapshot circuitry **114**. The mapper **102** is further configured to clear a given FP present indicator of the plurality of FP present indicators. The given FP present indicator that is cleared is associated with the section that is being transitioned into.

(101) For example, in an event the boundary **140a** is crossed, the FP present indicator **112b** that is associated with the section **139b**, would be cleared by the mapper **102**. By clearing the FP present indicator **112b**, the section **139b** is marked as having no association with an instruction that uses an FP AR as a destination. As instructions are mapped and the entries to the section **139b** are written by the mapper **102**, the mapper **102** may set the FP present indicator **112b** in an event an instruction associated with an entry in the section **139b** uses an FP AR as a destination.

(102) As disclosed above, in an alternative embodiment, the at least one FP present indicator **112** may be a counter (not shown). In an event the counter is zero, the mapper **102** may be further configured to disable copying of the FP mapper state **110** to the FP snapshot circuitry **116**. As such, in response to the change, the mapper **102** copies the integer mapper state **108** to the integer snapshot circuitry **114** but does not copy the FP mapper state **110**. In an event the counter is non-zero, in response to the change, the mapper **102** copies the integer mapper state **108** to the integer snapshot circuitry **114** and, since copy to the FP snapshot circuitry **116** is enabled due to the non-zero value of the counter, the mapper **102** also copies the FP mapper state **110** to the FP snapshot circuitry **116**.

(103) The journal **130** may be a circular buffer configured to store at most a maximum number of entries. According to an example embodiment, the maximum number of entries is 128. It should be understood, however, that the maximum number of entries may be any number that corresponds to a maximum number of instructions that can be in-flight in the OoO processor.

(104) The mapper **102** may be further configured to set the counter to twice the maximum number of entries in an event the instruction includes at least one instance of an FP AR used as a destination. The mapper **102** may be further configured to set the counter to twice the maximum number of entries in an event the counter is non-zero and a request for instruction unwinding is received. Such a request may be received from an issue unit (not shown) in the form of a notification, such as disclosed further below, that is provided by the issue unit along with a mapper identifier of a given instruction. The given instruction may be associated with the restart event. For example, execution of the given instruction may have caused the restart event.

(105) The mapper **102** may be further configured to decrement the counter in an event the instruction does not include at least one instance of an FP AR used as a destination. The mapper **102** may be further configured to disable copying of the FP mapper state **110** to the FP snapshot circuitry **116**, in an event the counter is zero, thus effecting power savings. The counter with the value of zero indicates that each FP snapshot **135a-d** of the FP snapshot circuitry **116** is identical to the FP mapper state **110**. The mapper **102** may be further configured to enable copying of the FP mapper state **110** to the FP snapshot circuitry **116**, in an event the counter is non-zero. The counter

having a non-zero value signifies that the FP mapper state **110** is not identical to each FP snapshot **135a-d**. An example embodiment in which the at least one FP present indicator **112** is the counter may be simpler to implement relative to an example embodiment in which the FP present indicator **112** includes a plurality of FP present indicators, however, the counter implementation may be slightly slower at detecting when copying from/to the FP snapshot circuitry **116** can be obviated. (106) Whether the at least one FP present indicator is employed to include a plurality of FP present indicators or is employed as a counter, the at least one FP present indicator is used to effect power savings of the OoO processor as a value(s) thereof may be used to determine when to block a snapshot of the FP mapper state **110** from being captured. Integer and FP snapshots are captured to expedite unwinding of instructions, such as disclosed below with regard to FIG. **1G**, however, if an FP AR has not been used in an instruction over a number of instructions, it can be determined that such a copy would be of no benefit as the FP mapper state **110** has not been modified based on mapping the number of instructions.

(107) FIG. **1G** is a block diagram of an example embodiment of the system **100** that may be used for unwinding instructions in the OoO processor. Since the OoO processor executes instructions out-of-order, that is, not according to a program order of the instructions generated by a compiler, instructions may need to be unwound in an event a restart event, such as an exception, branch/jump mispredict, etc., occurs. For example, a given instruction may be executed by the OoO processor causing the restart event. Since the OoO processor can execute out-of-order, instructions subsequent to the given instruction in the program order may have already been executed, even though such instructions follow the given instruction in the program order. Such instructions, that is, the subsequent instruction(s) following the given instruction in the program order, would be unwound by backing out any integer or FP mapper state changes that were made based on their mapping. Backing out such state changes is performed in an order that is reverse relative to the order in which they were applied. As such, unwinding undoes (i.e., reverses or unrolls) state changes made to the integer mapper state **108**, FP mapper state **110**, or a combination thereof, caused by mapping of the subsequent instruction(s).

(108) As disclosed above, mapping instructions that use registers as destination registers causes changes to a state of the mapper **102**. Specifically, the integer mapper state **108** is changed as a result of mapping an integer AR that is used as a destination register, and the FP mapper state **110** is changed as a result of mapping an FP AR that is used as a destination register. According to the example embodiment of FIG. **1G**, the mapper **102** may be configured, in response to a restart event causing at least one instruction to be unwound, to restore the present integer mapper state **108** and present FP mapper state **110** to a former integer mapper state (not shown) and former FP mapper state (not shown), respectively.

(109) The present integer mapper state **108** and FP mapper state **110** are used by the mapper **102** for mapping the instructions **104**, as disclosed above. Continuing with reference to FIG. **1G**, the system **100** comprises the integer snapshot circuitry **114** and FP snapshot circuitry **116** that are configured to store the integer snapshots **131a-m** and FP snapshots **135a-m** of the present integer mapper state **108** and FP mapper state **110**, respectively, to expedite restoration to the former integer and FP mapper state, respectively. Access to the FP snapshot circuitry **116** may be blocked, intermittently, as a function of the at least one FP present indicator **112** that is used by the mapper **102** to record presence of FP architectural registers (ARs) (not shown) used as destinations (not shown) in the instructions **104**.

(110) Restoring the present integer mapper state **108** and the present FP mapper state **110** to the former integer and FP mapper state, respectively, causes the former integer and FP mapper state to become the present integer mapper state **108** and the present FP mapper state **110**, respectively.

(111) The system **100** further comprises the integer-register mapper table **121** and integer physical register (PR) free list **118**, disclosed above with regard to FIG. **1C**. The present integer mapper state **108** represents the integer-register mapper table **121** in its present state and the integer-PR free list

118 in its present state. Each integer snapshot of the integer snapshots **131a-m** includes respective copies of the integer-register mapper table **121** and integer-PR free list **118** stored at a respective point in time, that is, when a change in sections of the journal **130**, written to by the mapper **102** during mapping, is detected by the mapper **102**, such as disclosed above with regard to FIG. **1E** and FIG. **1F**.

(112) The system **100** further comprises the FP-register mapper table **122** and FP-PR free list **124**, disclosed above with regard to FIG. **1D**. The present FP mapper state **110** represents the FP-register mapper table **122** in its present state and the FP-PR free list **124** in its present state. Each FP snapshot of the FP snapshots **135a-m** includes respective copies of the FP-register mapper table **122** and FP-PR free list **124** stored at a respective point in time, that is, at a time when copying to the FP snapshot circuitry **116** was enabled and a change in sections of the journal **130**, written to by the mapper **102**, occurred during mapping, such as disclosed above with regard to FIG. **1E** and FIG. **1F**.

(113) Continuing with reference to FIG. **1G**, the system **100** further comprises a journal, such as the journal **130** of FIG. **1E** or FIG. **1F**, disclosed above, an issue unit (not shown) and execution unit (not shown). The issue unit may issue the mapped instructions **106** to the execution unit to execute. Execution of a given instruction may cause a restart event (not shown). The issue unit may notify the mapper **102** of the restart event and provide a mapper identifier (not shown) associated with the given instruction. The mapper **102** may be further configured to use the mapper identifier to locate a given entry in the journal that is associated with the given instruction and to unwind mapper state change(s) recorded in entries that follow the given entry. The entries in the journal **130** that follow the given entry are associated with instructions that follow the given instruction in the program order. The mapper **102** may read those entries in reverse order to back out mapper state changes included therein, in a reverse order relative to an order applied during mapping. As disclosed above, such entries store integer mapper state changes made to the present integer mapper state **108** by the mapper **102** in order to map integer ARs used as destinations in the instructions **104**, and store FP mapper state changes made to the present FP mapper state **110** by the mapper **102** in order to map FP ARs used as destinations in the instructions **104**.

(114) Prior to backing out the mapper state changes for unwinding the instructions, the mapper **102** may access the integer snapshot circuitry **114** to copy a given integer snapshot of the integer snapshots **131a-m** to the integer mapper state **108** and may access the FP snapshot circuitry **116** to copy a given FP snapshot of the FP snapshots **135a-m** to the FP mapper state **110**. Access to the FP snapshot circuitry **116** may, however, be blocked based on the at least one FP present indicator. Such blocking prevents the copying of the given FP snapshot in an event the FP snapshots **135a-m** are identical to the FP mapper state **110** and, thus, effects a power savings. Regardless of whether access is blocked, the mapper **102** uses entries of the journal to restore the integer mapper state **108** and FP mapper state **110** to the former integer and FP mapper state, respectively, as disclosed in further detail below with regard to FIG. **2**.

(115) FIG. **2** is a block diagram of an example embodiment of a journal **230**. The journal **230** may be employed as the journal **130** that is used in the system **100**, as disclosed above. In the example embodiment, the journal **230** is a circular buffer configured to store a maximum of 128 entries and is partitioned into 4 sections, namely, section.sub.0, section.sub.1, section.sub.2, and section.sub.3. Each of the sections is configured to store 32 entries. It should be understood that an example embodiment of a journal disclosed herein is not limited to storing 128 entries or to having 4 sections each configured to store 32 entries.

(116) The sections of the journal **230** are separated by boundaries that include the boundary **240a**, boundary **240b**, boundary **240c**, and boundary **240d**. The boundaries separate last and first locations of consecutive sections. For example, the boundary **240a** separates a last location of section.sub.0, that is, the location.sub.31, from a first location of section.sub.1, that is, the location.sub.32. The boundary **240b** separates a last location of section.sub.1, that is, the

location.sub.63, from a first location of section.sub.2, that is, the location.sub.64. The boundary **240c** separates a last location of section.sub.2, that is, the location.sub.95, from a first location of section.sub.3, that is, the location.sub.96. The boundary **240d** separates a last location of section.sub.3, that is, the location.sub.127, from a first location of section.sub.1, that is, the location.sub.0.

(117) As the mapper **102** maps the instructions **104**, as disclosed above with regard to FIG. 1B, the mapper adds entries to locations of the journal **230** in a forward direction **245** and moves a head pointer **251** in the forward direction **245**. The head pointer **251** points to an empty location within the journal **230** that is a next entry to be written and is advanced in the forward direction after such next entry is written. The next entry to be written may be referred to interchangeably herein as a head entry **252**. A tail pointer **253** follows the head pointer **251** in the forward direction **245** and is advanced in the forward direction **245** when an entry of the journal **230** is consumed, that is, read from the journal **230**. An entry pointed to by the tail pointer **253** is a next entry to be read. The next entry pointed to by the tail pointer **253** may be referred to interchangeably herein as a tail entry **254**. A depth of entries of the circular buffer, that is, a depth of filled/valid entries, is based on a difference between the head pointer **251** and tail pointer **253**.

(118) As disclosed above, execution of a given instruction may cause a restart event. The issue unit may notify the mapper **102** of the restart event and provide a mapper identifier associated with the given instruction. The mapper **102** may be further configured to use the mapper identifier to locate a given entry **256** in the journal **230** that is associated with the given instruction. For example, in an event the mapper identifier is 0, the mapper **102** may determine that the given entry **256** is located at location.sub.0, whereas, in an event the mapper identifier is 95, the mapper **102** may determine that the given entry **256** is located at location.sub.95, etc. It should be understood that the given entry may be located at any location with the journal **230**.

(119) In response to the restart event, the mapper **102** unwinds mapper state change(s) recorded in entries that follow the given entry **256**. The entries in the journal **130** that follow the given entry **256** in the forward direction **245**, that is, the entries between the given entry **256** and the head entry **252**, are associated with instructions that follow the given instruction in the program order. The mapper **102** may read those entries in reverse order to back out mapper state changes included therein, in a reverse order relative to an order applied during mapping. As disclosed above, such entries store integer mapper state changes made to the present integer mapper state **108** by the mapper **102** in order to map integer ARs used as destinations in the instructions **104**, and store FP mapper state changes made to the present FP mapper state **110** by the mapper **102** in order to map FP ARs used as destinations in the instructions **104**.

(120) According to an example embodiment, the mapper **102** may copy a given integer and FP snapshot to the integer mapper state **108** and FP mapper state **110**, respectively, to expedite the unwinding. For example, in the example embodiment of FIG. 2, the given entry **256** is located within section.sub.0 and the head entry **252** is located in section.sub.3. As such, the mapper **102** may read the entries between the head entry **252** and the given entry **256** in a backward direction **247** starting at an entry that precedes the head entry **252** in the forward direction **245**. For each entry that is read, the mapper **102** may reverse the mapper state changes stored therein in the integer mapper state **108** and the FP mapper state **110** to restore the integer mapper state **108** and the FP mapper state **110** to the former integer and FP mapper state, respectively. In the example embodiment, however, where the given entry **256** is located with section.sub.0 and the head entry is located in section.sub.3, the mapper **102** may expedite such restoration by employing an integer and FP snapshot associated with the boundary **240a**.

(121) For example, instead of reversing all the mapper state changes stored in the entries between the head entry **252** and the given entry **256**, the mapper **102** may copy the integer and FP snapshot associated with the boundary **240a** to the integer mapper state **108** and the FP mapper state **110**, respectively. By reverting the integer mapper state **108** and the FP mapper state **110** to their

respective states captured when the boundary **240a** was crossed during mapping, the mapper **102** may restore the integer mapper state **108** and the FP mapper state **110** to the former integer and FP mapper state, respectively, based on the entry stored at location.sub.31, that is, the last entry of the section.sub.0, and any entries that may be present between the given entry **256** and the last entry of section.sub.0. A number of the entries that may be present between the given entry **256** and the last entry of section.sub.0 is less than a number of entries between the head entry **252** of section.sub.3 and the given entry **256** of section.sub.0 and, thus, expedites restoration relative thereto.

(122) To revert the integer mapper state **108** and the FP mapper state **110** to their respective states captured when the boundary **240a** was crossed during mapping, the mapper **102** copies a given integer snapshot and given FP snapshot to the integer mapper state and FP mapper state **110**, respectively. Access to the FP snapshot circuitry **116** is, however, blocked, intermittently, as a function of at least one FP present indicator. As such, the copy of the FP snapshot to the FP mapper state **110** may be blocked based on the at least one FP present indicator. Such blocking is performed for power savings, as disclosed above, when the FP snapshots stored in the FP snapshot circuitry **116** are identical to the FP mapper state **110**.

(123) In the example embodiment, following the copying, the mapper reads, in the backward direction **247**, the last entry of section.sub.0 and any entries located between the last entry of section.sub.0 and the given entry **256**, and reverses any mapper state changes stored therein. A number of the entries to read in the backward direction **247** may be based on respective mapper identifiers associated with the last entry and the given entry **256**. For example, a delta between the respective identifiers minus one may be the number of entries to read in the backward direction **247**. Based on the location of the given entry **256** and the head entry **252**, different pairs of the integer and FP snapshots, such as the integer snapshot **131a-m** and the FP snapshots **135a-m**, disclosed above, may be employed to expedite the restoration and, in some cases, the present integer mapper state **108** and present FP mapper state **110** may be employed, directly, without being reverted to respective integer and FP snapshots, as disclosed below.

(124) The given entry **256** that is associated with the instruction causing the restart event, is located within a given section of the plurality of sections, namely, section.sub.0 of the plurality of sections section.sub.0-section.sub.3 in the example embodiment of FIG. 2. In an event the head entry **252** is not in the given section, that is, section.sub.0 in the example embodiment, and, in an event the head entry **252** is in the given section and the depth is greater than a length of the given section, to restore the present integer and FP mapper state to the former integer and FP mapper state, respectively, the mapper **102** may be further configured to copy a given integer snapshot of the integer snapshots **131a-m** to the present integer mapper state **108** and to copy a given FP snapshot of the FP snapshots **135a-m** to the present FP mapper state **110**.

(125) For example, in the example embodiment, the head entry **252** is not located in the given section, that is, section.sub.0. As such, the integer and FP snapshots associated with the boundary **240a** may be employed. It also happens that the depth is greater than the length **32** of section.sub.0, in the example embodiment. However, it may be that the given entry **256** and head entry **252** are in a same section, in which case, the integer and FP snapshots may be employed so long as the depth is greater than a length of the section.

(126) Copying of the given FP snapshot is prevented in an event access to the FP snapshot circuitry **116** is blocked as a function of the at least one FP present indicator **112**. The given integer snapshot and given FP snapshot may be associated with a given boundary of the boundaries, as disclosed above. The given boundary separates the given section and a next section of the plurality of sections. The given boundary is crossed as a function of the mapper transitioning from writing to the given section in the circular buffer to writing to the next section in the circular buffer, such as disclosed further above with regard to FIG. 1F.

(127) The mapper **102** may be further configured to use the mapper identifier to select the given integer snapshot from among the integer snapshots **131a-m** and to select the given FP snapshot

from among the FP snapshots **135a-m**. For example, the integer snapshot **131a** and FP snapshot **135a** may be associated with a range of mapper identifiers and the given integer and FP snapshots may be selected based on the mapper identifier associated with the given entry **256** being in that range.

(128) In an event the given entry **256** is not a last entry of the given section, the mapper **102** may be further configured to read, without affecting the tail pointer **253**, from the journal **230** in the backward direction **247**, starting with the last entry. The mapper **102** may be further configured to read, in reverse order, each subsequent entry of at least one subsequent entry that was added to the given section, in the forward direction **245**, subsequent to adding the given entry **256** to the given section. The reverse order is reverse relative to a fill order used to add the given entry **256** and the at least one subsequent entry. The backward direction **247** is opposite the forward direction **245**. The mapper **102** may be further configured to move the head pointer **251** to point to a next entry in the circular buffer. The next entry immediately follows the given entry **256** in the forward direction **245**. For example, after reading the last entry at location.sub.31 and entries between the last entry at location.sub.31 and the given entry **256**, in the backward direction **247**, the mapper **102** may set the head pointer **251** to which entry immediately follows the given entry **256** in the forward direction **245**.

(129) In an event the subsequent entry that is read includes at least one integer mapper state change of the integer mapper state changes, the mapper is further configured to unwind, from the present integer mapper state **108**, each integer mapper state change of the at least one integer mapper state change. For example, referring back to FIG. 1C, the integer mapper state change may be unwound by changing a present mapping in the integer-register mapper table **121**, that is between an integer AR and a present integer PR, to a former mapping, that is between the integer AR and a former integer PR, and returning the present integer PR to the integer PR free list **118**. The integer AR and former integer PR are included in the subsequent entry that is read.

(130) In an event the subsequent entry that is read includes at least one FP mapper state change of the FP mapper state changes, the mapper is further configured to unwind, from the present FP mapper state **110**, each FP mapper state change of the at least one FP mapper state change. For example, referring back to FIG. 1D, the FP mapper state change may be unwound by changing a present mapping in the FP register mapper table **122**, that is between an FP AR and a present FP PR, to a former mapping, that is between the FP AR and a former FP PR, and returning the present FP PR to the FP PR free list **124**. The FP AR and former FP PR are included in the subsequent entry that is read.

(131) Continuing to refer to FIG. 2, in an event the head entry **252** is in the given section, that is, section.sub.0 in the example embodiment, and the depth is not greater than the length of the given section, to restore the present integer and FP mapper state to the former integer and FP mapper state, respectively, the mapper is further configured to read, without affecting the tail pointer, from the circular buffer in a backward direction, starting with a preceding entry. The preceding entry precedes the head entry **252** in the given section. The mapper reads, in reverse order, each subsequent entry of at least one subsequent entry located in the given section between the head entry **252** and the given entry **256**. The reverse order is reverse relative to a fill order used to add, in the forward direction **245**, the given entry **256** and each subsequent entry of the at least one subsequent entry to the given section. The mapper **102** is further configured to move the head pointer **251** to point to a next entry in the journal **230**. The next entry immediately follows the given entry **256** in the forward direction **245**.

(132) In an event the subsequent entry that is read includes at least one integer mapper state change of the integer mapper state changes, the mapper is further configured to unwind, from the present integer mapper state, each integer mapper state change of the at least one integer mapper state change. Referring back to FIG. 1C, the integer mapper state change may be unwound by changing a present mapping in the integer-register mapper table **121**, that is between an integer AR and a

present integer PR, to a former mapping, that is between the integer AR and a former integer PR, and returning the present integer PR to the integer PR free list **118**. The integer AR and former integer PR are included in the subsequent entry that is read.

(133) In an event the subsequent entry that is read includes at least one FP mapper state change of the FP mapper state changes, the mapper **102** is further configured to unwind, from the present FP mapper state **110**, each FP mapper state change of the at least one FP mapper state change.

Referring back to FIG. **1D**, the FP mapper state change may be unwound by changing a present mapping in the FP register mapper table **122**, that is between an FP AR and a present FP PR, to a former mapping, that is between the FP AR and a former FP PR, and returning the present FP PR to the FP PR free list **124**. The FP AR and former FP PR are included in the subsequent entry that is read.

(134) FIG. **3** is a flow diagram of a method for instruction mapping in an out-of-order (OoO) processor (**300**). The method begins (**302**) and maps instructions by mapping integer and floating-point (FP) architectural registers (ARs) of the instructions to integer and FP physical registers (PRs) of the OoO processor, respectively, based on integer mapper state and FP mapper state, respectively (**304**). The method records, via at least one FP present indicator, presence of FP ARs used as destinations in the instructions (**306**). The method copies, periodically, the integer mapper state to integer snapshot circuitry (**308**). The method copies, intermittently, based on the at least one FP present indicator, the FP mapper state to FP snapshot circuitry (**310**), and the method thereafter ends (**312**), in the example embodiment.

(135) The method may further comprise writing a respective entry to a journal for each instruction, the journal partitioned into a plurality of sections with respective boundaries therebetween. The method may further comprise copying the integer mapper state to the integer snapshot circuitry, periodically, responsive to a change in sections of the journal written and copying the FP mapper state to the FP snapshot circuitry, intermittently, based on the at least one FP present indicator and the change in sections.

(136) The journal may be a circular buffer with a head pointer and a tail pointer and the method may further comprise detecting the change in sections based on a modification made to the head pointer.

(137) The integer mapper state may represent an integer-register mapper table in its present state and an integer-PR free list in its present state and copying the integer mapper state to the integer snapshot circuitry may include copying, in response to the change, the integer-register mapper table to a given integer-register-map snapshot of a plurality of integer-register-map snapshots included in the integer snapshot circuitry. The copying may further include copying the integer-PR free list to a given integer-PR-free-list snapshot of a plurality of integer-PR-free-list snapshots included in the integer snapshot circuitry. The given integer-register-map snapshot and the given integer-PR-free-list snapshot may be associated with a given boundary of the respective boundaries, the given boundary crossed based on the change.

(138) The given integer-register-map snapshot may include a first respective arrangement of circuitry. The given integer-PR-free-list snapshot may include a second respective arrangement of circuitry. Copying the integer mapper state to the integer snapshot circuitry may further include storing a respective copy of the integer-register mapper table in the first respective arrangement of circuitry and storing a respective copy of the integer-PR free list in the second respective arrangement of circuitry.

(139) The FP mapper state may represent an FP-register mapper table in its present state and an FP physical register (PR) free list in its present state. In an event copying of the FP mapper state to the FP snapshot circuit is enabled based on the at least one FP present indicator, the method may further comprise copying, in response to the change, the FP-register mapper table to a given FP-register-map snapshot of a plurality of FP-register-map snapshots included in the FP snapshot circuitry, and copying, in response to the change, the FP-PR free list to a given FP-PR-free-list

snapshot of a plurality of FP-PR-free-list snapshots included in the FP snapshot circuitry. The given FP-register-map snapshot and the given FP-PR-free-list snapshot may be associated with a given boundary of the respective boundaries, the given boundary crossed based on the change.

(140) The given FP-register-map snapshot may include a first respective arrangement of circuitry. The given FP-PR-free-list snapshot may include a second respective arrangement of circuitry. The method may further comprise storing a respective copy of the FP-register mapper table in the first respective arrangement of circuitry and storing a respective copy of the FP-PR free list in the second respective arrangement of circuitry.

(141) The at least one FP present indicator may include a plurality of FP present indicators, each FP present indicator of the plurality of FP present indicators associated, on a one-to-one basis, with a respective section of the plurality of sections of the journal.

(142) The method may further comprise initializing each FP present indicator of the plurality of FP present indicators to be set.

(143) The change may be from a first section of the journal to a second section of the journal and the method may further comprise reading each FP present indicator of the plurality of FP present indicators in response to the change. The method may further comprise, in an event each FP present indicator of the plurality of FP present indicators is clear, disabling copying of the FP mapper state to the FP snapshot circuitry. The method may further comprise, in an event at least a single FP present indicator of the plurality of FP present indicators is set, copying, in response to the change, the FP mapper state to the FP snapshot circuitry and clearing a given FP present indicator of the plurality of FP present indicators. The given FP present indicator may be associated with the second section.

(144) The at least one FP present indicator may be a counter and the method may further comprise, in an event the counter is zero, disabling copying of the FP mapper state to the FP snapshot circuitry and, in an event the counter is non-zero, copying, in response to the change, the FP mapper state to the FP snapshot circuitry.

(145) The integer mapper state may represent an integer-register mapper table in its present state and an integer physical register (PR) free list in its present state. The FP mapper state may represent an FP-register mapper table in its present state and an FP-PR free list in its present state.

(146) The integer-register mapper table may be a lookup table (LUT) including a plurality of entries. The method may further comprise indexing each entry of the plurality of entries of the LUT via a unique integer architectural register (AR) of a plurality of integer ARs of the OoO processor, each entry referencing a unique integer PR of the integer PRs of the OoO processor. The integer ARs of the instructions may be from among the plurality of integer ARs of the OoO processor.

(147) The FP-register mapper table may be a LUT including a plurality of entries. The method may further comprise indexing each entry of the plurality of entries of the LUT via a unique FP AR of a plurality of FP ARs of the OoO processor, each entry referencing a unique FP PR of the FP PRs of the OoO processor. The FP ARs of the instructions may be from among the plurality of FP ARs of the OoO processor.

(148) The method may further comprise identifying free integer PRs via the integer-PR free list and identifying free FP PRs via the FP-PR free list. The free integer PRs may be unmapped integer PRs and the free FP PRs may be unmapped FP PRs.

(149) Mapping the instructions may include, for each instruction, determining whether the instruction includes at least one instance of an integer AR used as a source and, in an event the instruction includes the at least one instance, using the integer-register mapper table to map a respective integer AR of each instance of the at least one instance to a respective integer PR of the OoO processor.

(150) Mapping the instructions may include, for each instruction, determining whether the instruction includes at least one instance of an FP AR used as a source, and in an event the instruction includes the at least one instance, using the FP mapper register table to map a respective

FP AR of each instance of the at least one instance to a respective FP PR of the OoO processor.

(151) Mapping the instructions may include, for each instruction, writing an entry to a journal for the instruction. Content of the entry may represent an effect or lack thereof on the integer or FP mapper state that resulted from mapping of the instruction.

(152) Mapping the instructions may further include mapping a given number of instructions on a cycle-by-cycle basis and writing at least one entry, of the given number, to the journal on the cycle-by-cycle basis.

(153) In an event an actual number of instructions received in a cycle is less than the given number, mapping the instructions may further include writing the at least one entry, of the given number, to the journal and, in at least one respective entry of the at least one entry written, indicating via the content that the effect is no effect. A total number of the at least one respective entry is a difference between the given number and the actual number.

(154) In an event the instruction has no instance of either an integer or FP AR used as a destination, the effect is no effect and mapping the instruction may further include indicating, via the content of the entry, that no change to either the integer or FP mapper state resulted from mapping the instruction.

(155) In an event the instruction includes at least one instance of an integer AR used as a destination, the effect may include at least one change to the integer mapper state and mapping the instruction may further include including, in the content, for each instance of the at least one instance, the integer AR, a present integer PR, and a next integer. The integer-register mapper table, in its present state, includes a mapping between the integer AR and the present integer PR. Prior to mapping of the instruction, the next integer PR is a free integer PR. Mapping the instruction may further include removing the free integer PR from the integer-PR free list and changing the mapping to be between the integer AR and the next integer PR, causing the mapper to map the integer AR of the instruction to the next integer PR.

(156) In an event the mapper is notified of completion of the instruction by the OoO processor, the method may further comprise retiring the entry from the journal and adding, based on the content, the present integer PR of each instance of the at least one instance to the integer-PR free list.

(157) In an event the instruction includes at least one instance of an FP AR used as a destination, the effect includes at least one change to the FP mapper state, and mapping the instruction may further include updating the at least one FP indicator and including in the content, for each at least one instance, the FP AR, a present FP PR, and a next FP PR. The FP-register mapper table, in its present state, includes a mapping between the FP AR and the present FP PR. Prior to mapping of the instruction, the next FP PR is a free FP PR. Mapping the instruction may further include removing the free FP PR from the FP-PR free list and changing the mapping to be between the FP AR and the next FP PR, causing the mapper to map the FP AR of the instruction to the next FP PR.

(158) In an event the mapper is notified of completion of the instruction by the OoO processor, the method may further comprise retiring the entry from the journal and adding, based on the content, the present FP PR of each instance of the at least one instance to the FP-PR free list.

(159) The journal may be partitioned into a plurality of sections. The entry is located within a given section of the plurality of sections. The at least one FP present indicator may include a plurality of FP present indicators. Each FP present indicator of the plurality of FP present indicators may be associated with a respective section of the plurality of sections on a one-to-one basis. In an event the instruction includes at least one instance of an FP AR used as a destination, mapping the instruction may further include setting a given FP present indicator of the plurality of FP present indicators. The given FP present indicator may be associated with the given section.

(160) The at least one FP present indicator may be a counter. The journal may be a circular buffer configured to store at most maximum number of entries. The method may further comprise setting the counter to twice the maximum number of entries in an event the instruction includes at least one instance of an FP AR used as a destination. The method may further comprise setting the

counter to twice the maximum number of entries in an event the counter is non-zero and a request for instruction unwinding is received. The method may further comprise decrementing the counter in an event the instruction does not include the at least one instance. The method may further comprise disabling copying of the FP mapper state to the FP snapshot circuitry, in an event the counter is zero, and enabling copying of the FP mapper state to the FP snapshot circuitry, in an event the counter is non-zero.

(161) FIG. 4 is a flow diagram 400 of an example embodiment of a method for unwinding instructions in an out-of-order (OoO) processor. The method begins (402) and, in response to a restart event causing at least one instruction to be unwound, restores a present integer mapper state and present floating-point (FP) mapper state to a former integer mapper state and former FP mapper state, respectively, wherein the present integer and FP mapper state are used for mapping instructions (404). The method stores integer snapshots and FP snapshots of the present integer and FP mapper state in integer snapshot circuitry and FP snapshot circuitry, respectively, to expedite the restoring (406). The method blocks access to the FP snapshot circuitry, intermittently, as a function of at least one FP present indicator used to record presence of FP architectural registers (ARs) used as destinations in the instructions (408), and the method thereafter ends (410) in the example embodiment.

(162) The present integer mapper state represents an integer register mapper table in its present state and an integer PR free list in its present state. Each integer snapshot of the integer snapshots includes respective copies of the integer register mapper table and integer PR free list stored at a respective point in time. The restoring may include selecting a given integer snapshot of the integer snapshots, copying a given integer-register-map snapshot and given integer-PR-free-list snapshot of the given integer snapshot to the integer register mapper table and integer PR free list, respectively, and modifying the integer register mapper table and integer PR free list based on a journal.

(163) The present FP mapper state represents an FP register mapper table in its present state and an FP PR free list in its present state. Each FP snapshot of the FP snapshots includes respective copies of the FP register mapper table and FP PR free list stored at a respective point in time. The restoring may include selecting a given FP snapshot of the FP snapshots, copying, in an event the access is not blocked, a given FP-register-map snapshot and given FP-PR-free-list snapshot of the given FP snapshot to the FP register mapper table and FP PR free list, respectively, and modifying the FP register mapper table and FP PR free list based on the journal.

(164) The method may further comprise, in response to the restart event, using a mapper identifier to locate a given entry in a journal. The mapper identifier is received with a notification of the restart event. The mapper identifier and given entry are associated with a given instruction associated with the restart event.

(165) Blocking access to the FP snapshot circuitry, intermittently, may include blocking access to the FP snapshot circuitry in an event each FP present indicator of the plurality of FP present indicators is clear and enabling access to the FP snapshot circuitry in an event at least a single FP present indicator of the plurality of FP present indicators is set.

(166) The journal may be a circular buffer configured to store at most a maximum number of entries, the at least one FP present indicator may be a counter, and the method may further comprise setting the counter to twice the maximum number of entries each time a received instruction that uses at least one FP architectural register (AR) as a destination is mapped. The method may further comprise decrementing the counter each time a received instruction that does not use at least one FP AR as a destination is mapped. The method may further comprise, in response to the restart event, setting the counter to twice the maximum number of entries in an event the counter is non-zero. The method may further comprise blocking access to the FP snapshot circuitry in an event the counter is zero and enabling access to the FP snapshot circuitry in an event the counter is non-zero.

(167) Mapping the instructions may include storing, in the journal, integer mapper state changes

and FP mapper state changes made to the present integer mapper state and present FP mapper state, respectively. The integer mapper state changes are caused by mapping integer ARs used as destinations in the instructions to integer physical registers (PRs) of the OoO processor. The FP mapper state changes are caused by mapping the FP ARs used as destinations in the instructions to FP PRs of the OoO processor.

(168) The journal may be a circular buffer with a head pointer configured to point to a head entry and a tail pointer configured to point to a tail entry. A depth of entries of the circular buffer is based on a difference between the head and tail pointers and the given entry is located within a given section of the plurality of sections. In an event the head entry is not in the given section, and in an event the head entry is in the given section and the depth is greater than a length of the given section, the restoring may include copying a given integer snapshot of the integer snapshots to the present integer mapper state and copying a given FP snapshot of the FP snapshots to the present FP mapper state, wherein copying of the given FP snapshot is prevented in an event access to the FP snapshot circuitry is blocked as a function of the at least one FP present indicator.

(169) Restoring may include using the mapper identifier to select the given integer snapshot from among the integer snapshots and to select the given FP snapshot from among the FP snapshots.

(170) In an event the given entry is not a last entry of the given section, the restoring may include reading, without affecting the tail pointer, from the circular buffer in a backward direction, starting with the last entry. The reading may include reading, in reverse order, each subsequent entry of at least one subsequent entry that was added to the given section, in a forward direction, subsequent to adding the given entry to the given section. The reverse order is reverse relative to a fill order used to add the given entry and the at least one subsequent entry. The backward direction is opposite the forward direction. The restoring may further include moving the head pointer to point to a next entry in the circular buffer, the next entry immediately following the given entry in the forward direction.

(171) In an event the subsequent entry that is read includes at least one integer mapper state change of the integer mapper state changes, the restoring includes unwinding, from the present integer mapper state, each integer mapper state change of the at least one integer mapper state change.

(172) In an event the subsequent entry that was read includes at least one FP mapper state change of the FP mapper state changes, the restoring includes unwinding, from the present FP mapper state, each FP mapper state change of the at least one FP mapper state change.

(173) In an event the head entry is in the given section and the depth is not greater than the length of the given section, the restoring includes reading, without affecting the tail pointer, from the circular buffer in a backward direction, starting with a preceding entry. The preceding entry precedes the head entry. The reading includes reading, in reverse order, each subsequent entry of at least one subsequent entry located in the given section between the head entry and the given entry. The reverse order is reverse relative to a fill order used to add, in forward direction, the given entry and each subsequent entry of the at least one subsequent entry to the given section. The backward direction is opposite the forward direction. The restoring may further include moving the head pointer to point to a next entry in the circular buffer, the next entry immediately following the given entry in the forward direction.

(174) In an event the subsequent entry that is read includes at least one integer mapper state change of the integer mapper state changes, the restoring includes unwinding, from the present integer mapper state, each integer mapper state change of the integer mapper state changes. The restoring may include unwinding, from the present integer mapper state, each integer mapper state change of the at least one integer mapper state change by changing a present mapping in the integer register mapper table, that is between an integer AR and a present integer PR, to a former mapping, that is between the integer AR and a former integer PR. The restoring may further include returning the present integer PR to the integer PR free list, wherein the integer AR and former integer PR are included in the subsequent entry read.

(175) In an event the subsequent entry that is read includes at least one FP mapper state change of the FP mapper state changes, the restoring includes unwinding, from the present FP mapper state, each FP mapper state change of the FP mapper state changes. The restoring may include unwinding, from the present FP mapper state, each FP mapper state change of the at least one FP mapper state change by changing a present mapping in the FP register mapper table, that is between an FP AR and a present FP PR, to a former mapping, that is between the FP AR and a former FP PR. The restoring may further include returning the present FP PR to the FP PR free list, wherein the FP AR and former FP PR are included in the subsequent entry read.

(176) FIG. 5 is a flow diagram **500** of a method for mapping and unwinding instructions in an out-of-order (OoO) processor. The method begins (**502**) and uses integer mapper state and floating-point (FP) mapper state for mapping instructions (**504**). The method records, via at least one FP present indicator, presence of FP architectural registers used as destinations in the instructions (**506**). The method writes to integer snapshot circuitry and FP snapshot circuitry, periodically (**508**). The method reads from the integer and FP snapshot circuitry responsive to a restart event causing at least one instruction to be unwound (**510**). The method blocks, intermittently, as a function of the at least one FP present indicator, the writing to and reading from the FP snapshot circuitry (**512**) and the method thereafter ends (**514**), in the example embodiment.

(177) Writing to the integer snapshot circuitry may include copying the integer mapper state to a given integer snapshot of the integer snapshots and writing to the FP snapshot circuitry may include copying the FP mapper state to a given FP snapshot of the FP snapshots.

(178) Reading from the integer snapshot circuitry may include copying a given integer snapshot of the integer snapshots to the integer mapper state and reading from the FP snapshot circuitry may include copying a given FP snapshot of the FP snapshots to the FP mapper state.

(179) FIG. 6 is a block diagram of an example embodiment of a network services processor **650** in which an example embodiment disclosed herein may be implemented. The network services processor **650** may process Open System Interconnection network L2-L7 layer protocols encapsulated in received packets. As is well-known to those skilled in the art, the Open System Interconnection (OSI) reference model defines seven network protocol layers (L1-L7). The physical layer (L1) represents the actual interface, electrical and physical that connects a device to a transmission medium. The data link layer (L2) performs data framing. The network layer (L3) formats the data into packets. The transport layer (L4) handles end to end transport. The session layer (L5) manages communications between devices, for example, whether communication is half-duplex or full-duplex. The presentation layer (L6) manages data formatting and presentation, for example, syntax, control codes, special graphics and character sets. The application layer (L7) permits communication between users, for example, file transfer and electronic mail.

(180) The network services processor **650** may schedule and queue work (packet processing operations) for upper level network protocols, for example L4-L7, and allow processing of upper level network protocols in received packets to be performed to forward packets at wire-speed. Wire-speed is the rate of data transfer of the network over which data is transmitted and received. By processing the protocols to forward the packets at wire-speed, the network services processor **650** does not slow down the network data transfer rate.

(181) A packet is received for processing by an interface unit **622**. The interface unit **622** performs pre-processing of the received packet by checking various fields in the network protocol headers (e.g., L2, L3 and L4 headers) included in the received packet, and may perform checksum checks for TCP/User Datagram Protocol (UDP) (L3 network protocols). The interface unit **622** may receive packets via multiple network interface protocols, such as Ethernet and Peripheral Component Interconnect Express (PCIe). In a further embodiment, the interface unit **622** may be configured to receive packets from a plurality of X Attachment Unit Interfaces (XAUIs), Reduced X Attachment Unit Interfaces (RXAUIs), Serial Gigabit Media Independent Interfaces (SGMIIs), 40GBASE-R, 50GBASE-R, and/or 100GBASE-R. The interface unit **622** may also prepare and

transmit outgoing packets via one or more of the aforementioned interfaces.

(182) The interface unit **622** may write packet data into buffers in the last level cache and controller (LLC) **630** or external DRAM **608**. The packet data may be written into the buffers in a format convenient to higher-layer software executed in at least one processor core of the processor cores **620a-k**. Thus, further processing of higher level network protocols is facilitated.

(183) The network services processor **650** can also include one or more application specific co-processors. These co-processors, when included, offload some of the processing from the processor cores **620a-k**, thereby enabling the network services processor **650** to achieve high-throughput packet processing.

(184) An I/O bridge **638** is configured to manage the overall protocol and arbitration and provide coherent I/O portioning with an I/O Bus **642**. The I/O bridge **638** may include buffer queues for storing information to be transferred between a coherent memory interconnect (CMI) **644**, the I/O Bus **642**, and the interface unit **622**. The I/O bridge **638** may comprise a plurality of individual bridges on which communications and arbitration can be distributed.

(185) The miscellaneous I/O interface (MIO) **616** can include auxiliary interfaces such as General Purpose I/O (GPIO), Flash, IEEE 802 two-wire Management Data I/O Interface (MDIO), Serial Management Interface (SMI), Universal Asynchronous Receiver-Transmitters (UARTs), two-wire serial interface (TWSI), and other serial interfaces.

(186) A Schedule/Sync and Order (SSO) module **648** queues and schedules work for the processor cores **620a-k**. Work is queued by adding a work queue entry to a queue. For example, a work queue entry is added by the interface unit **622** for each packet arrival. A timer unit **649** is used to schedule work for the processor cores **620a-k**.

(187) The processor cores **620a-k** request work from the SSO module **648**. The SSO module **648** selects (i.e., schedules) work for one of the processor cores **620a-k** and returns a pointer to the work queue entry describing the work to a given processor core of the processor cores **620a-k**.

(188) Each processor core includes an instruction cache **652** and Level-1 data cache **154**. In one embodiment, the network services processor **650** includes 24 processor cores **620a-k**. In some embodiments, each of the processor cores **620a-k** may be an implementation of the Arm® architecture, such as the Armv8.2 64-bit architecture, and may be compatible with the Armv8.2 software ecosystem and include hardware floating-point, single instruction multiple data (SIMD), and memory management unit (MMU) support. In such an embodiment, consistent with the Armv8.2 architecture, the processor cores **620a-k** may contain full hardware support for virtualization. Guest operating systems can thus run at Arm defined user and operating system privilege levels, and hypervisor software can run in a separate higher privilege level. The processor cores **620a-k** may also support a secure state in which software may run in three different privilege levels while hardware provides isolation from the non-secure state. It should be understood that a total number of the processor cores **620a-k** is not limited to 24 and that an architecture of the processor cores **620a-k** is not limited to a 64-bit architecture or to the Armv8.2 64-bit architecture.

(189) Last level cache and controller (LLC) **630** and external DRAM **608** are shared by all of the processor cores **620a-k** and I/O co-processor devices (not shown). Each processor core is coupled to the LLC **630** by the CMI **644**. The CMI **644** is a communication channel for all memory and I/O transactions between the processor cores **620a-k**, the I/O bridge **638** and the LLC **630**. In one embodiment, the CMI **644** is scalable to multiple (e.g., 24) processor cores **620a-k**, supporting fully-coherent Level-1 data caches **654** with write through. The CMI **644** may be highly-buffered with the ability to prioritize I/O.

(190) The controller of the LLC **630** maintains memory reference coherence. It returns the latest copy of a block for every fill request, whether the block is stored in LLC **630**, in external DRAM **608**, or is “in-flight.” A plurality of DRAM controllers **633** supports the external DRAM **608**, and can support preferred protocols, such as the DDR4 protocol.

(191) After a packet has been processed by the processor cores **620a-k**, the interface unit **622** reads

the packet data from the LLC **630**, DRAM **608**, performs L4 network protocol post-processing (e.g., generates a TCP/UDP checksum), forwards the packet through the interface unit **622** and frees the LLC **630**/DRAM **608** used by the packet. The DRAM Controllers **633** manage in-flight transactions (loads/stores) to/from the DRAM **608**.

(192) A resource virtualization unit (RVU) **662** may enable software to map various local function (LF) resources in various modules into several physical functions (PFs) and virtual functions (VFs). This enables multi-unit software drivers compatible with Linux Windows® and the data plane development kit (DPDK).

(193) A management module **626** may include various units for managing operation of the network services processor **650**. For example, the management module **626** may include a temperature sensor, a power serial bus master interface to determine current performance and energy consumption, and a memory diagnostic controller to detect and report memory errors. The management module **26** may further include control processors, such as a system control processor for power management and other secure chip management tasks, and a module control processor for module management and other non-secure chip management tasks.

(194) While example embodiments have been particularly shown and described, it will be understood by those skilled in the art that various changes in form and details may be made therein without departing from the scope of the embodiments encompassed by the appended claims.

Claims

1. A mapper configured to: restore a present floating-point (FP) mapper state to a former FP mapper state, the present FP mapper state restored by the mapper in response to a restart event causing at least one instruction to be unwound, the present FP mapper state used by the mapper for mapping instructions; and access FP snapshot circuitry used to store FP snapshots of the present FP mapper state, access to the FP snapshot circuitry blocked intermittently, as a function of a value of at least one FP present indicator, the value used by the mapper to record a representation of whether or not there is a presence of at least one FP architectural register (AR) used as a destination in the instructions.

2. The mapper of claim 1, wherein restoring the present FP mapper state to the former FP mapper state causes the former FP mapper state to become the present FP mapper states.

3. The mapper of claim 1, wherein: the present FP mapper state represents a FP register mapper table in its present state and a FP PR free list in its present state; each FP snapshot of the FP snapshots includes respective copies of the FP register mapper table and the FP PR free list stored at a respective point in time; and in response to the restart event, the mapper is further configured to: select a FP snapshot of the FP snapshots; copy, in an event the access is not blocked, a FP-register-map snapshot and a FP-PR-free-list snapshot of the FP snapshot to the FP register mapper table and the FP PR free list, respectively; and modify the FP register mapper table and the FP PR free list based on a journal.

4. The mapper of claim 1, wherein, in response to the restart event, the mapper is further configured to use a mapper identifier to locate an entry in a journal, the mapper identifier received by the mapper with a notification of the restart event, the mapper identifier and entry associated with an instruction associated with the restart event.

5. The mapper of claim 4, wherein: the journal is partitioned into a plurality of sections with boundaries therebetween; the at least one FP present indicator includes a plurality of FP present indicators; and each FP present indicator of the plurality of FP present indicators is associated with a respective section of the plurality of sections.

6. The mapper of claim 5, wherein the mapper is further configured to: block access to the FP snapshot circuitry in an event each FP present indicator of the plurality of FP present indicators is clear; and enable access to the FP snapshot circuitry in an event at least a single FP present

indicator of the plurality of FP present indicators is set.

7. The mapper of claim 4, wherein the journal is a circular buffer configured to store at most a maximum number of entries, wherein the at least one FP present indicator is a counter, and wherein the mapper is further configured to: set the counter to twice the maximum number of entries each time the mapper maps a received instruction that uses at least one FP architectural register (AR) as a destination; decrement the counter each time the mapper maps a received instruction that does not use at least one FP AR as a destination; in response to the restart event, set the counter to twice the maximum number of entries in an event the counter is non-zero; block access to the FP snapshot circuitry in an event the counter is zero; and enable access to the FP snapshot circuitry in an event the counter is non-zero.

8. The mapper of claim 4, wherein the journal is configured to store FP mapper state changes made to the present FP mapper state by the mapper.

9. The mapper of claim 8, wherein the FP mapper state changes are caused by mapping FP architectural registers (ARs) used as destinations in the instructions to FP PRs of an out-of-order (OoO) processor.

10. The mapper of claim 8, wherein: the journal is a circular buffer with a head pointer configured to point to a head entry and a tail pointer configured to point to a tail entry, a depth of entries of the circular buffer is based on a difference between the head and tail pointers; and the entry is located within a section of the plurality of sections.

11. The mapper of claim 10, wherein, in an event the head entry is not in the section and wherein, in an event the head entry is in the section and the depth is greater than a length of the section, to restore the present FP mapper state to the former FP mapper state, the mapper is further configured to: copy a FP snapshot of the FP snapshots to the present FP mapper state, wherein copying of the FP snapshot is prevented by block logic circuitry in an event access to the FP snapshot circuitry is blocked as a function of the at least one FP present indicator.

12. The mapper of claim 11, wherein the FP snapshot is associated with a boundary of the boundaries, the boundary separating the section and a next section of the plurality of sections, the boundary crossed as a function of the mapper transitioning from writing to the section in the circular buffer to writing to the next section in the circular buffer.

13. The mapper of claim 11, wherein the mapper is further configured to use the mapper identifier to select the FP snapshot from the FP snapshots.

14. The mapper of claim 11, wherein the length is 32 entries.

15. The mapper of claim 11, wherein, in an event the entry is not a last entry of the section, the mapper is further configured to: read, without affecting the tail pointer, from the circular buffer in a backward direction, starting with the last entry, in order to read, in reverse order, each subsequent entry of at least one subsequent entry that was added to the section, in a forward direction, subsequent to adding the entry to the section, wherein the reverse order is reverse relative to a fill order used to add the entry and the at least one subsequent entry, the backward direction opposite the forward direction; and move the head pointer to point to a next entry in the circular buffer, the next entry immediately following the entry in the forward direction.

16. The mapper of claim 15, wherein the present FP mapper state represents a FP register mapper table in its present state and a FP-physical register (PR) free list in its present state, wherein, in an event a subsequent entry of the at least one subsequent entry read includes at least one FP mapper state change of the FP mapper state changes, the mapper is further configured to unwind, from the present FP mapper state, each FP mapper state change of the at least one FP mapper state change by changing a present mapping in the FP register mapper table that is between a FP AR and a present FP PR to a former mapping that is between the FP AR and a former FP PR and returning the present FP PR to the FP PR free list, wherein the FP AR and former FP PR are included in subsequent entry.

17. The mapper of claim 15, wherein the at least one instruction to be unwound is subsequent to the

instruction in a program order and executed by an execution unit prior to execution of the instruction by the execution unit.

18. The mapper of claim 11, wherein, in an event the head entry is in the section and the depth is not greater than the length of the section, to restore the present FP mapper state to the former FP mapper state, the mapper is further configured to: read, without affecting the tail pointer, from the circular buffer in a backward direction, starting with a preceding entry, the preceding entry preceding the head entry, in order to read, in reverse order, each subsequent entry of at least one subsequent entry located in the section between the head entry and the entry, wherein the reverse order is reverse relative to a fill order used to add, in a forward direction, the entry and each subsequent entry of the at least one subsequent entry to the section, the backward direction opposite the forward direction; and move the head pointer to point to a next entry in the circular buffer, the next entry immediately following the entry in the forward direction.

19. The mapper of claim 18, wherein, in an event a subsequent entry of the at least one subsequent entry read includes at least one FP mapper state change of the FP mapper state changes, the mapper is further configured to unwind, from the present FP mapper state, each FP mapper state change of the at least one FP mapper state change.

20. The mapper of claim 18, wherein the at least one instruction to be unwound is subsequent to the instruction in a program order and executed by an execution unit prior to execution of the instruction by the execution unit.

21. A method comprising: restoring present floating-point (FP) mapper state to a former FP mapper state, the present FP mapper state restored in response to a restart event causing at least one instruction to be unwound, the present FP mapper state used for mapping instructions; and accessing FP snapshot circuitry used to store FP snapshots of the present FP mapper state, access to the FP snapshot circuitry blocked intermittently, as a function of a value of at least one FP present indicator, the value used to record a representation of whether or not there is a presence of at least one FP architectural register (AR) used as a destination in the instructions.

22. The method of claim 21, wherein restoring the present FP mapper state to the former FP mapper state causes the former FP mapper state to become the present FP mapper state.

23. The method of claim 21, wherein the present FP mapper state represents a FP register mapper table in its present state and a FP PR free list in its present state, wherein each FP snapshot of the FP snapshots includes respective copies of the FP register mapper table and the FP PR free list stored at a respective point in time, and wherein the restoring includes: selecting a FP snapshot of the FP snapshots; copying, in an event the access is not blocked, a FP-register-map snapshot and a FP-PR-free-list snapshot of the FP snapshot to the FP register mapper table and the FP PR free list, respectively; and modifying the FP register mapper table and the FP PR free list based on the journal.

24. The method of claim 21, further comprising, in response to the restart event, using a mapper identifier to locate an entry in a journal, the mapper identifier received with a notification of the restart event, the mapper identifier and entry associated with an instruction associated with the restart event.

25. The method of claim 24, wherein: the journal is partitioned into a plurality of sections with boundaries therebetween; the at least one FP present indicator includes a plurality of FP present indicators; and each FP present indicator of the plurality of FP present indicators is associated with a respective section of the plurality of sections.

26. The method of claim 25, further comprising blocking access to the FP snapshot circuitry intermittently and wherein the blocking includes: blocking access to the FP snapshot circuitry in an event each FP present indicator of the plurality of FP present indicators is clear; and enabling access to the FP snapshot circuitry in an event at least a single FP present indicator of the plurality of FP present indicators is set.

27. The method of claim 24, wherein the journal is a circular buffer configured to store at most a

maximum number of entries, wherein the at least one FP present indicator is a counter, and wherein the method further comprises: setting the counter to twice the maximum number of entries each time a received instruction that uses at least one FP architectural register (AR) as a destination is mapped; decrementing the counter each time a received instruction that does not use at least one FP AR as a destination is mapped; in response to the restart event, setting the counter to twice the maximum number of entries in an event the counter is non-zero; blocking access to the FP snapshot circuitry in an event the counter is zero; and enabling access to the FP snapshot circuitry in an event the counter is non-zero.

28. The method of claim 24, wherein mapping the instructions includes storing, in the journal, FP mapper state changes made to the present FP mapper state.

29. The method of claim 28, wherein the FP mapper state changes are caused by mapping FP architectural registers (ARs) used as destinations in the instructions to FP PRs of an out-of-order (OoO) processor.

30. The method of claim 28, wherein: the journal is a circular buffer with a head pointer configured to point to a head entry and a tail pointer configured to point to a tail entry, a depth of entries of the circular buffer is based on a difference between the head and tail pointers; and the entry is located within a section of the plurality of sections.

31. The method of claim 30, wherein, in an event the head entry is not in the section and wherein, in an event the head entry is in the section and the depth is greater than a length of the section, the restoring includes: copying a FP snapshot of the FP snapshots to the present FP mapper state, wherein copying of the FP snapshot is prevented via block logic in an event access to the FP snapshot circuitry is blocked as a function of the at least one FP present indicator.

32. The method of claim 31, wherein the FP snapshot is associated with a boundary of the boundaries, the boundary separating the section and a next section of the plurality of sections, the boundary crossed as a function of transitioning from writing to the section in the circular buffer to writing to the next section in the circular buffer.

33. The method of claim 31, wherein the restoring includes using the mapper identifier to select the FP snapshot from the FP snapshots.

34. The method of claim 31, wherein the length is 32 entries.

35. The method of claim 31, wherein, in an event the entry is not a last entry of the section, the restoring includes: reading, without affecting the tail pointer, from the circular buffer in a backward direction, starting with the last entry, in order to read, in reverse order, each subsequent entry of at least one subsequent entry that was added to the section, in a forward direction, subsequent to adding the entry to the section, wherein the reverse order is reverse relative to a fill order used to add the entry and the at least one subsequent entry, the backward direction opposite the forward direction; and moving the head pointer to point to a next entry in the circular buffer, the next entry immediately following the entry in the forward direction.

36. The method of claim 35, wherein the present FP mapper state represents a FP register mapper table in its present state and a FP PR free list in its present state, and wherein, in an event a subsequent entry of the at least one subsequent entry read includes at least one FP mapper state change of the FP mapper state changes, the restoring includes: unwinding, from the present FP mapper state, each FP mapper state change of the at least one FP mapper state change by changing a present mapping in the FP register mapper table that is between a FP AR and a present FP PR to a former mapping that is between the FP AR and a former FP PR; and returning the present FP PR to the FP PR free list, wherein the FP AR and former FP PR are included in the subsequent entry.

37. The method of claim 36, wherein the at least one instruction to be unwound is subsequent to the instruction in a program order and executed by an execution unit prior to execution of the instruction by the execution unit.

38. The method of claim 31, wherein, in an event the head entry is in the section and the depth is not greater than the length of the section, the restoring includes: reading, without affecting the tail

pointer, from the circular buffer in a backward direction, starting with a preceding entry, the preceding entry preceding the head entry, in order to read, in reverse order, each subsequent entry of at least one subsequent entry located in the section between the head entry and the entry, wherein the reverse order is reverse relative to a fill order used to add, in forward direction, the entry and each subsequent entry of the at least one subsequent entry to the section, the backward direction opposite the forward direction; and moving the head pointer to point to a next entry in the circular buffer, the next entry immediately following the entry in the forward direction.

39. The method of claim 38, wherein, in an event a subsequent entry of the at least one subsequent entry read includes at least one FP mapper state change of the FP mapper state changes, the restoring includes unwinding, from the present FP mapper state, each FP mapper state change of the at least one FP mapper state change.

40. The method of claim 38, wherein the at least one instruction to be unwound is subsequent to the instruction in a program order and executed by an execution unit prior to execution of the instruction by the execution unit.

41. A system comprising: a mapper configured to use floating-point (FP) mapper state for mapping instructions and configured to record, via a value of at least one FP present indicator, a representation of whether or not there is a presence of at least one FP architectural register used as a destination in the instructions; and FP snapshot circuitry configured to store FP snapshots of the FP mapper state, the mapper further configured to read from the FP snapshot circuitry responsive to a restart event causing at least one instruction to be unwound, the mapper blocked intermittently, as a function of the value of the at least one FP present indicator, from writing to and reading from the FP snapshot circuitry.

42. The system of claim 41, wherein the mapper is further configured to write to the FP snapshot circuitry, periodically, wherein, to write to the FP snapshot circuitry, the mapper is further configured to copy the FP mapper state to a FP snapshot of the FP snapshots.

43. The system of claim 41, wherein, to read from the FP snapshot circuitry, the mapper is further configured to copy a FP snapshot of the FP snapshots to the FP mapper state.

44. A method comprising: using floating-point (FP) mapper state for mapping instructions; recording, via a value of at least one FP present indicator, a representation of whether or not there is a presence of at least one FP architectural register used as a destination in the instructions; and reading from FP snapshot circuitry responsive to a restart event causing at least one instruction to be unwound, access to the FP snapshot circuitry blocked intermittently, as a function of the value of the at least one FP present indicator, the FP snapshot circuitry used to store FP snapshots of the FP mapper state.

45. The method of claim 44, further comprising writing to the FP snapshot circuitry periodically and wherein: writing to the FP snapshot circuitry includes copying the FP mapper state to a FP snapshot of the FP snapshots.

46. The method of claim 44, wherein reading from the FP snapshot circuitry includes copying a FP snapshot of the FP snapshots to the FP mapper state.

47. An apparatus comprising: means for restoring a present floating-point (FP) mapper state to a former FP mapper state, the present FP mapper state restored in response to a restart event causing at least one instruction to be unwound, the present FP mapper state used for mapping instructions; and means for accessing FP snapshot circuitry used to store FP snapshots of the present FP mapper state, access to the FP snapshot circuitry blocked intermittently, as a function of a value of at least one FP present indicator, the value used to record a representation of whether or not there is a presence of at least one FP architectural register (AR) used as a destination in the instructions.

48. A method comprising: means for using floating-point (FP) mapper state for mapping instructions; means for recording, via a value of at least one FP present indicator, a representation of whether or not there is a presence of at least one FP architectural register used as a destination in the instructions; and means for reading from FP snapshot circuitry responsive to a restart event

causing at least one instruction to be unwound, access to the FP snapshot circuitry blocked intermittently, as a function of the value of the at least one FP present indicator, the FP snapshot circuitry used to store FP snapshots of the FP mapper states.
